

FINAL REPORT



Sixth

General Service Conference of A.A.



1956

OKLAHOMA STATE COMMITTEE
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through General Service Conference Delegates, Committeemen or
Group Representatives)

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

It has been said of previous Conferences that they were composed of men and women who had great confidence in the future of A.A., in the Conference structure and in their own ability to help strengthen The Third Legacy of service to the alcoholics of the world.

It can be said that the mood or sense of the Sixth Annual General Service Conference was also one of great confidence.

It was, however, a kind and degree of confidence that was appreciably different from that of other Conferences.

For the confidence of this Conference seemed to stem from an experience and maturity that had not been apparent in similar degree in the past. The difference was one that might be measured in the phrase "tested experience." Where earlier Delegates had been confident that they could reach certain objectives in the future, the Conferencees of 1956 could, in many, many cases, look back upon successful experience within the Conference structure.

Earlier Delegates knew what they hoped to do.

This year's Delegates knew what they had been able to do---and were not afraid to hope to do better. They knew the problems involved in working on Area Committees. They understood the difficulties of trying to convince a "sophisticated" old-timer that A.A.'s world services deserved support.

Perhaps it might be suggested that this was a Conference of practical A.A.'s whose underlying idealism had never been corrupted by cynicism. They were A.A.'s who had seen the consistently beneficial results of the "collective conscience" of the Fellowship when it was permitted to evolve freely. They were Delegates who retained confidence that this collective conscience would continue to serve the movement well.

This was a gathering in which the inherent stability of the Conference structure itself no longer appeared to be on trial. In the recurring recitals of problems encountered or failures suffered, there was never the slightest suggestion that A.A. should look beyond the Conference, or by-pass it, in seeking to assure its survival.

This was a Conference whose members were acutely aware that service, as we know and need it in A.A., is a two-way proposition. They recognized clearly, for example, that the effectiveness of General Service Headquarters activities is closely related to the information and cooperation available to Staff members from the field. And they showed growing awareness of the importance of making increasingly effective use of Area Committeemen and General Service Representatives. Delegates, they said in effect, cannot expect to do a sound local contact job entirely on their own.

THE SENSE OF THE CONFERENCE

(Continued)

It was a Conference that reenforced the fundamental right of all Delegates to be totally informed on any or all aspects of General Service Headquarters operations. Never before has so much data on Headquarters activities been made available to Delegates.

The crowded agenda for the Sixth Conference was, in itself, a tribute to the burgeoning of A.A. worldwide. It was also significant that a number of the policy problems submitted for Conference consideration involved practical matters that might be classified loosely under the heading of "public relations." Public relations has always been a concern of the movement. But rarely in the history of the society has it been confronted with so many urgent, immediate, practical problems in this area. Despite this, the Delegates consistently directed attention to the important distinction between public relations matters of movement-wide import and those which fall within the scope of local A.A. autonomy.

> In a Fellowship where no one can speak for the movement as a whole, it may be presumptuous to even suggest that one brief summary can express the sense of a Conference of more than four score A.A.s from the North American continent and overseas.

But assuredly it violates no tradition to report that the Sixth Conference, in its eagerness to serve, its anxiety to be informed and its experience based on confidence, reflected a vigorous, growing Society that has never forgotten that its primary purpose is to help the still-suffering alcoholic who may turn to us today...tomorrow... and the next day.

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"PETITION, APPEAL, PARTICIPATION AND DECISION--
PRINCIPLES OF A.A. SERVICE"

Remarks by Bill at Final 1956 Conference Session

(NOTE: In his closing remarks to the Conference, traditionally a high point of all such meetings, Bill proposed consideration of four principles "that might some day permeate all of A.A.'s services." Many who heard this talk, which is digested below, believe it is one of Bill's most significant statements.)

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God has been good to Alcoholics Anonymous. These sessions of the Sixth General Service Conference now ending have marked the time when our Society has taken its first step into the brave new world of our future. Never have we felt more confident, more assured of the years to come than we do this afternoon.

This Conference thinks, I am sure, that its main structural concepts are approximately right. I am thinking of the relation of A.A. groups to their Assemblies, the method of choosing Committeemen and Delegates, the relation of the Delegates to the Trustees, Directors and Headquarters Staffs; also the relation of the Trustees, essentially a body of custody, to the operating services of the Headquarters, the Grapevine, Service office and A.A. Publishing. These interlocking relations are something for high confidence already based on considerable experience. Nevertheless we shall remain aware that these structures can be changed if they fail to work. Our Charter can always be amended.

And of course, we shall always be much concerned with those lesser refinements that can improve the working of our main structure.

On the first evening here, I explained some of our recent improvements of this character - how our newly-formed Budget Committee is a fresh assurance that we can't go broke, how our new Policy Committee can avert blunders in this area and take the back-breaking load of minor matters off the Trustees, how our Nominating Committee can insure good choices of new Staff members, Directors and Trustees. In short, our Board of Trustees is now fitted with eyes, ears and a nose that can guarantee a much improved functioning. So far, so good.

But our structure of service is no empty blueprint. It is manned by people who feel and think and who act. Therefore any principles or devices that can better relate them to each other in a harmonious and effective whole are worth considering.

So I now offer you four principles that might someday permeate all of A.A.'s services, principles which express tolerance, patience and love of each other; principles which could do much to avert friction, indecision and power-driving. These are not really new principles; unconsciously we have been making use of them right along. I simply propose to name them and, if you like them, their scope and application can, over coming years, be fully defined.

"PETITION, APPEAL, PARTICIPATION AND DECISION"

(Continued)

Here are the words for them: petition, appeal, participation and decision. Maybe all this sounds a bit vague and abstract. So let's develop the meaning and application of these four words.

Take petition. Actually this is an ancient device to protect minorities. It is for the redress of grievances. Every A.A. member, inside or outside our services, should have the right to petition his fellows. Some years ago, for example, a group of my old friends on the outside became violently opposed to the idea of this Conference. They feared it would ruin A.A. To put it mildly, they thought they had a grievance. So they placed their ideas on paper and petitioned the A.A. groups to stop the Conference. Lots of our members got sore; they said this group had no right to do this. But they really did have the right, didn't they?

Yet in our services, this right is often forgotten or unused. It is my belief that every person working in A.A.'s services should feel free to petition for a redress of grievances or an improvement of conditions. I would make this personal right unlimited. Under it, a boy wrapping books in our shipping room could petition the Board of A.A. Publishing, the Board of Trustees, or indeed, the whole Conference if he chose to do so -- and this without the slightest prejudice against him. Of course, he'd seldom carry this right so far. But its very existence, and everybody's knowledge of it, would go far to stop those morale breakers of undue domination and petty tyranny.

Let's look now at the right of appeal. A century ago a young Frenchman named De Tocqueville came to this country to look at the new Republic. Despite the fact that his family had suffered loss of life and property in the French Revolution, this nobleman-student had begun to love democracy and to believe in its future. His writing on this subject is still a classic. But he did express one deep fear for the future; he feared the tyranny of the majority, especially that of the uninformed, the angry, or the close majority. He wanted to be sure that minority opinion could always be well heard and never trampled upon. How very right he was has already been sensed by this Conference.

Therefore, I propose that we further insure, in A.A. service matters, the right of appeal. Under it, the minority of any committee, corporate Board, or a minority of the Board of Trustees, or a minority of this Conference, could continue to appeal, if they wished, all the way forward to the whole A.A. movement, thus making the minority voice both clear and loud.

As a matter of practice, this right, too, would seldom be carried to extremes. But again, its very existence would make majorities careful of acting in haste or with too much cocksureness. In this connection we should note that our Charter already requires in many cases a two-thirds vote (and in some instances a three-quarters vote) for action. This is to prevent hasty or inconsiderate decision by a close majority. Once set up and defined, this right of appeal could greatly add to our protection.

"PETITION, APPEAL, PARTICIPATION AND DECISION"

(Continued)

Now we come to participation. The central concept here is that all Conference members are on our service team. Basically we are all partners in a common enterprise of World Service. Naturally there has to be a division of duties and responsibilities among us. Not all of us can be elected Delegates, appointed Trustees, chosen Directors, or become hired Staff members. We have to have our respective authorities, duties and responsibilities to serve; otherwise, we couldn't function.

But in this quite necessary division, there is a danger - a very great danger - something that will always need watching. The danger is that our Conference will commence to function along strict class lines.

The elected Delegates will want all, or most all, of the Conference votes so they can be sure to rule the Trustees. The Trustees will tend to create committees and corporate boards composed exclusively of themselves, the better to rule and direct those working daily at the office, Grapevine and A.A. Publishing. And, in their turn, the volunteer Directors of the Grapevine and Publishing Company will tend to exclude from their own Board any of the paid Staff members, people who so often carry the main burden of doing the work. To sum it up: the Delegates will want to rule the Trustees, the Trustees will want to rule the corporations and the corporate directors will want to rule the hired Staff members.

Now Headquarters experience has already proved that this state of affairs means complete ruin of morale and function. That is why Article Twelve of your Conference Charter states that "No Conference member shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over another."

In the early days, this principle was hard to learn. Over it we had battles, furious ones. For lack of a voting seat on the several boards and committees that ran her office, for lack of defined status and duties, and because she was "just hired help," and a woman besides, one of the most devoted Staff members we ever had completely cracked up. She had too many bosses, people who sometimes knew less and carried less actual responsibilities than she. She could not sit in the same board or committee room as a voting equal. No alcoholic can work under this brand of domination and paternalism.

This was the costly lesson that now leads us to the principle of participation.

Participation means, at the Conference level, that we are all voting equals; a Staff member's vote is guaranteed as good as anyone's. Participation also means, at the level of the Headquarters, that every corporate Board or Committee shall always contain a voting representation of the executives directly responsible for the work to be done, whether they are Trustees or not, or whether they are paid or volunteer workers. This is why, today, the president of A.A. Publishing and the senior Staff member at the A.A. office are both Directors and both vote on the Board of A.A. Publishing. This puts them on a partnership basis with the Trustee and other members of the Publishing Board. It gives them a service standing and an authority commensurate with their actual duties and responsibilities. Nor is this just a beautiful idea of brotherhood. This is standard American corporate business practice everywhere, something that we had better follow when we can.

"PETITION, APPEAL, PARTICIPATION AND DECISION"

(Continued)

In this connection I am hopeful that the principal assistant to the Editor of The Grapevine, the person who has the immediate task of getting the magazine together, will presently be given a defined status and seated on the Grapevine's Board as a voting director.

So much, then, for the principle and practice of "participation".

Now, what about decision?

Our Conference and our Headquarters has to have leadership. Without it, we get nowhere. And the business of leadership is to lead.

The three principles just described - petition, appeal and participation - are obviously checks upon our leadership, checks to prevent our leadership running away with us. Clearly this is of immense importance.

But of equal importance is the principle that leaders must still lead. If we don't trust them enough, if we hamstringing them too much, they simply can't function. They become demoralized and either quit or get nothing done.

How, then, are A.A.'s service leaders to be authorized and protected so that they can work as executives, as committees, as boards or trustees or even as a Service Conference, without undue interference in the ordinary conduct of A.A.'s policy and business?

The answer lies, I think, in trusting our leadership with proper powers of decision, carefully and definitely defined.

We shall have to trust our executives to decide when they shall act on their own, and when they should consult their respective committees or boards. Likewise, our Policy, Public Information and Finance Committees should be given the right to choose (within whatever definitions of their authority are established) whether they will act on their own or whether they will consult the Board of Trustees. (Our Headquarters can, of course, have no secrets.)

Similarly, the Grapevine and A.A. Publishing Boards should be able to decide when to act on their own and when to consult the full Board of Trustees.

The Trustees, in their turn, must positively be trusted to decide which matters they shall act upon, and which they will refer to the Conference as a whole. But where, of course, any independent action of importance is taken, a full report should afterward be made to the Conference.

And last, but not at all the least, the Conference itself must also have a definite power of decision. It cannot rush back to the grassroots with all its problems or even with many of them. In my belief the Conference should never take a serious problem

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(Continued)

to the grassroots until it knows what its own opinion is, and what the "pros" and "cons" of such a problem really are. It is the function of Conference leadership to instruct the Group Conscience on the issues concerned. Otherwise, an instruction from the grassroots which doesn't half know the score can be very confusing or quite wrong.

Therefore Conference Delegates must have complete liberty to decide what questions shall be referred to the A.A. groups and just how and when this is to be done.

The conscience of A.A. is certainly our ultimate authority. But the grassroots will have to trust the Conference to act in most matters and only the Conference can decide which these are. The Conference, however, must at all times stand ready to have its opinion reversed by its constituent groups, but only after these groups have been thoroughly informed of the issues involved.

Such, I think, are the several powers of decision that our Conference and Headquarters leadership must have or else fail in their duty. Anarchy may theoretically be a beautiful form of association, but it cannot function. Dictatorship is efficient, but ultimately it goes wrong and becomes demoralized. Of course A.A. wants neither.

Therefore, we want leadership that can lead, yet one which can be changed or restrained. Servants of our fellowship, however, our leaders must always remain. But we surely want leaders who are enabled to act in small matters without constant interference. We want a Conference that will remain extremely responsible to A.A. opinion, yet a body completely able to act alone for us when necessary - even in some great and sudden crisis.

Such then could become the A.A. service principle of decision.

If we now begin to incorporate these words -- petition, appeal, participation and decision -- into our service thinking and action, I believe that many of our confusions about A.A.'s service functioning will begin to disappear. More harmony and effectiveness will gradually replace those service gears that still grind and strain among us.

Of course, I am not now announcing these as permanent principles for definite adoption. I only offer them as ideas to ponder until we meet again in 1957.

BILL AND THE CONFERENCE

For Bill, the Sixth Annual General Service Conference of A.A. was, in many significant ways, another milestone in his long identification with the simple program of recovery from alcoholism.

A decade ago, he had foreseen the imperative necessity of some structure in which A.A. tradition and principle could be safeguarded for future generations. As he has so often remarked, the Conference idea encountered both apathy and resistance when it was first proposed. It required several years before there was sufficient unanimity among the Trustees of the time to assure a five-year trial of Bill's "visionary" plan for better linkage between the Groups and the General Service Board (then known as The Alcoholic Foundation.)

In 1951, the first Conference members -- relatively inexperienced in movement-wide affairs, untried in their new role of "servants, not legislators," uncertain of the true significance of their historic role -- had met in New York City. They demonstrated two things: (1) That there was, in truth, a need for two-way channels of communication between the groups and Service Headquarters, and (2) That the great spiritual bonds which unite A.A.s in an expanding, worldwide Fellowship are stronger than any local, divisive factors that have arisen to this day.

It would be unrealistic to deny that, to a large degree, Bill "carried" that first Conference on his own lanky shoulders. Proud of their role but lacking full confidence in themselves, lacking personal knowledge of Service Headquarters and its personnel, the first Delegates time and again turned to Bill for historical background, for guidance on policy decisions, for clarification of many points.

Yet such is the nature of the man called Bill that it could never be said, or what is more important, felt -- that this surviving co-founder of A.A. dominated that first Conference or those others that led up to the drama of St. Louis. Implicit in all his comments was a belief and faith that the collective conscience of A.A., rather than the breadth of experience or the superior insight of any one person, would show A.A.s how to live and work together and carry this program outward and forward.

The drama of St. Louis was one not often seen in human societies in our time. It was a drama in which Bill went on stage only to cross over the footlights, stepping down from his untitled role as leader to become one among many members. Behind the drama lay months and years of thought and planning and consultation, crystallized in the "Third Legacy Manual" and its permanent charter for the General Service Conference.

Bill's vision had become a reality. His faith in the collective conscience of A.A. had been justified. And by deliberately turning away from the trappings of responsibility, which in others might have masked the armor of power, he set an example which all will agree should long endure.

In stepping aside as the sponsor and protector of the Conference, how would Bill continue to serve A.A.? What would be his new role in the movement and what purpose would it serve? Indeed, was there to be an appropriate, productive role for a "retired co-founder?" Perhaps these were some of the questions in Bill's mind as the 1956 Conference drew near. Perhaps they were also in the minds of Delegates who had seen or heard of the drama of St. Louis.

BILL AND THE CONFERENCE

(Continued)

In fact, one Delegate to the Sixth Conference asked whether Bill still had "voting status" in the Conference. The answer to this question was easy. The permanent charter of the Conference provides that the surviving co-founder shall continue to be a member of that body.

The answers to the other questions were not so easy to determine. They could not be answered by Bill alone but required confirmation by Delegates themselves. For the Conference is no longer "a project of Bill's." It has become a delicate, responsive instrument of A.A. as a whole.

The lack of knowledge of movement-wide A.A. apparent in the first Conference has been superseded by the broader understanding displayed by Delegates to the Sixth Conference. Uncertainty and timidity have given way, not necessarily to arrogant certainty, but at least to a degree of maturity in Third Legacy affairs that was not possible in an earlier day.

In an earlier day, Delegates called upon Bill, frequently and unabashedly, for information.

In the 1956 Conference, Delegates required less information. They were more aware of the purposes and operations of the Conference structure, more willing to try to clarify problems by themselves rather than ask Bill to clarify them. They spoke with an independence and assurance that come from experience. And they spoke often in terms of specific problems for which they sought specific solutions.

Where did Bill fit into this "new" type of Conference, this gathering of men and women to whom he, as a symbol of our earliest members, had bequeathed the Third Legacy of service and responsibility?

Strangely---or perhaps not so strangely---the Delegates instinctively seemed to have assigned to Bill a role that no one else in A.A. can fill so well, a role that, by a curious paradox, may be even more important than that of "co-founder."

It is a role for which there is no resounding title. Its title, if one might be required would be: "The Reminder."

Wise men learn most from their errors and the errors of their fellows. But most men tend to forget their most instructive experience and the memories of some men are short and teach nothing.

It is becoming increasingly common in A.A. to say that our Twelve Traditions reflect our collective experience and summarize those principles which seem most likely to assure survival of our Fellowship. But few in our society can reach back in memory to the actual experiences upon which our Traditions are based; none can do so with the breadth of understanding that is Bill's special gift.

BILL AND THE CONFERENCE

(Continued)

Today, and for many todays to come, A.A. needs and will need a "Reminder" who can bring alive the instructive memories of our perilous early years, who can recall for us the errors made in human frailty and the errors avoided by happy chance or, as most may prefer to believe, by the help of a benign Providence.

History is elusive memory preserved for the benefit of future generations. The eagerness with which the 1956 Delegates endorsed Bill's preliminary historical project was a symbol of the Fellowship's dependence on Bill as a "Reminder" of our as-yet-unrecorded past.

Interpretation might be defined as examination of both experience and memory to recall the purposes and motives underlying things written or done in the past. The Delegates' dependence on Bill for interpretation of several aspects of the Conference charter was, again, a call upon the services of a "Reminder."

There will undoubtedly be occasions, as was suggested during consideration of the structure of the Board of Trustees, when Delegates and others in positions of service will express their tributes to Bill-the-co-founder and discount his role as Bill-"The-Reminder."

Few, least of all Bill, would claim that this is unhealthy for A.A.

Many men have the opportunity or luck to be "founders." But not all men have the capacity to continue to serve their fellows as "Reminders," as men who use hindsight to sharpen foresight, who not only learn from experience but can teach from experience, who can preserve the delicate balance between respect for the past and appreciation of current and future needs. ✓

We are thankful that Bill had the luck to be a co-founder of A.A. We are even more grateful that he has the more demanding qualities required for his vitally-important role of "Reminder" in our fortunate Fellowship.

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"PRINCIPLES, POLICIES AND PRACTICES"

Closing Remarks by Bernard B. Smith, Chairman, General Service Board of A. A.

(NOTE: At the closing session of the Conference Bill paid a special tribute to A.A.'s good friend, Bernard Smith, on the occasion of the latter's imminent resignation as Chairman of the Board of Trustees after many years of service to the Society. As a memento of his personal affection, Bill presented "Bern" with an inscribed photograph of the historic Sunday session of the St. Louis Convention.)

Tomorrow I will cease to be Chairman of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, and as you are aware, when I am no longer the Chairman of the Board, I similarly am no longer the Chairman of the General Service Conference.

Since, therefore, no further authority will be delegated to me except that implicit in the right to vote as a Trustee of the Board and as a member of this Conference, I regard it as desirable that I talk today to you about principles, policies and practices of the Conference in relation to the General Service Board. I would have preferred, as I have in the past, to talk about the spiritual basis of Alcoholics Anonymous, and of its potent promise as a way of life for all of human society. However, I feel that I can provide a greater service in this, the last time I shall be addressing you as Chairman, by talking of the practical operation of our great society, rather than of its spiritual content, although I hope that in the hammering out of appropriate methods of operation, the spiritual base of A. A. will never be overlooked.

It is not easy to draw precise lines of demarcation between what is a principle of operation, what is a policy, and what is a practice. Perhaps I can illustrate the distinction best by referring to specific actions of the Conference.

I would regard, for example, as a principle of operation, the issue we have passed upon at this Conference, and have had occasion to debate in the past, namely, the composition of the Board of Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, that is, whether or not a majority of the members of the Board shall be non-alcoholics or whether, as has been proposed, this ratio should be modified. With respect to a principle of operation, we should endeavor to achieve overwhelming approval of the General Service Conference. It is in the area of principles that we must endeavor to reach conclusions, not by compromise but with certainty.

Policy would represent in effect an expression of the collective judgment of the Conference which the General Service Board should be guided by in order to carry out the work which, by the nature of the structure of A. A., is delegated to it. Policy, for example, would be represented by such discussion as took place yesterday on the use of television broadcasting as a means of communicating the message of A. A. Since the American people spend more time watching television than they devote to all other spare-time activities put together, I would feel that a policy necessarily had to be evolved for the

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(Continued)

guidance of the General Service Board as to the use of this medium in reaching our still-suffering alcoholics and their families in the living-rooms of America. Now the actual detailed use of television must be delegated inevitably to the General Service Board and the A. A. Publishing Company, for television is, in my view, a means of publication and communication in virtually the same sense as the publication of our books and pamphlets.

It is my considered opinion that on matters of policy the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous requires the assurance implicit in a decision on policy arrived at by a vote of a substantial majority of the Conference. A. A. principles do not yield to change readily, and it is therefore with respect to principles that certainty is essential. In the area of policy, while we should endeavor to achieve certainty, we should not limit the effective functioning of the services of A. A. by insisting upon absolute certainty; for policy can be changed whenever the collective voice of A. A., speaking through the Conference, determines that in actual operation the policy as adopted by a previous Conference requires change.

Now a practice, as I see it, would constitute that class of decisions which generally relate to the business operations of the services of Alcoholics Anonymous. I would regard as a practice, for example, the decision made at last year's Conference as to the discounts to be allowed in the purchase of the publications of A. A. Publishing, Inc. Two years ago the Conference voted to abolish discounts as a means of adding to the reserve fund of the General Service Board. A year later, after a study of the effect of the abolition of discounts, the Conference voted to reinstate discounts on a basis then determined by the Conference.

In the area of a practice, as distinguished from a principle, it may be necessary and, indeed, frequently will be necessary, to arrive at a compromise. While we would never like to see the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous divorced even from business practices, nevertheless books have to be published, a decision must be made as to the terms on which books are to be sold, and so in this area of practices, if we cannot achieve certainty, we must accept compromise. The services of A. A. must go on. But we should understand clearly that we are not, in reaching a decision on practices, attempting to influence a subsequent Conference from changing a practice, so that whenever experience in A. A. indicates a need for a change in services, a Conference must feel that in so doing it is not violating any concept that a previous Conference has arrived at. And so I would say that in the area of principles, we should secure virtual certainty; in the area of policy, comparative certainty, and in the area of practices, compromise if necessary.

I have deliberately avoided the use of the word "traditions" in these observations, because I regard the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous as the only traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, unless they are changed or amended in keeping with the resolution adopted at the 20th Anniversary Convention of A. A. held in St. Louis last year.

I should like to refer now to certain aspects of the role of a delegate to the Conference. A delegate, in my view, while he must be conscious of area reaction, should not come to a Conference as an instructed representative of the area from which he is chosen. He is a representative who serves all of Alcoholics Anonymous during the period

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(Continued)

he is a conferee, and he must feel at all times free to be persuaded, by the arguments presented in the course of discussions at the Conference, to vote in a manner that may differ from the thinking of the area which elected him. If the area which elected him has indicated its views on a specific proposal, he can of course communicate the views of his area, but he must never feel bound by them in voting. We must be conscious in our deliberations of the needs of small group as well as of the needs of the large groups, and must think at these Conferences of the collective needs of all of A. A. On all matters that are vital to the great Society of A. A., the Conference must give ample opportunity to all delegates to express their opinions and present their arguments, whether these opinions or arguments represent their own thinking or that of the area.

The obligation of a chairman at a Conference is great indeed. He should endeavor, through discussion, to determine the prevailing opinion of the Conference before a motion is made. However, a Chairman does not have the right to prevent a member of the Conference who himself begins to have a feeling of the sense of the Conference, from making a motion. However, once a motion is made and it is seconded, and the Chair asks for discussion on the motion, delegates still have an opportunity to express their views, and on any matter of consequence, the Chair should not close off discussion until delegates have had an ample opportunity to discuss the motion.

Delegates should be careful to refrain from insisting on the motion being passed upon until others have had an opportunity to express the grounds for their opposition to a motion, for we have seen in practice in these first six Conferences that there will be times when a delegate will express a point of view that had not occurred to any of us, and that as a result, a motion which had been made that would seem to represent the sense of the Conference is withdrawn. We must be careful, it seems to me, because of our normal desire to complete the work of a Conference within the scheduled time, not to discourage discussion.

I have always regarded the discussions at the Conferences, and the freedom of expression implicit in the Conference, as, if anything, more valuable than the actual decisions arrived at at the Conference. For it is out of these discussions that the Conference and the movement itself has an opportunity to have displayed before it all the facets of thinking of all the areas of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Now what I have had to say about the operations of the Conferences represent just one man's point of view, namely my own. What I have said represents conclusions that I have arrived at, which of course are not binding upon anybody. While I hope they will not be entirely disregarded, the Conferences are free to discard them as unsound; for I can only express that which I feel, that which I see, and that which I observe in terms of my own desire to serve the great Society of A. A.

And now, in these closing moments, I would like to make a few personal observations about A. A. with which many of you may not agree, but which stem from my experience of seeing A. A. in action.

"PRINCIPLES, POLICIES AND PRACTICES"

(Continued)

We have found a way of life which arrests the disease of alcoholism by living by the concepts of life contained in our Twelve Steps. What has interested me, and will always interest me primarily, so far as A. A. is concerned, is not to determine what causes the disease of alcoholism, not to determine why the Twelve Steps provide us with a spiritual basis for living which makes it unnecessary for us to drink again, but to know that it does work. I rather prefer to leave to outside scientific inquiry any study of the why's of alcoholism, and the study of why living within our Twelve Steps renders it possible for us to live without alcohol.

This precious message which we have received, and by which we live, has resulted in our achieving a far greater measure of human happiness than is the lot of the average human being who walks the earth today, who has not been subjected to the acute suffering of alcoholism. We must always be concerned, however, with the structure of Alcoholics Anonymous which protects this way of life, for we will always owe an obligation to the generations yet unborn, to insure that this way of life is available to them, as it has been to us.

I regard the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous as the outstanding spiritual achievement of this century; and it is the obligation of this generation to insure that it exists as long as this earth of ours spins around the sun; for I, as a so-called non-alcoholic, see in the concepts of living of Alcoholics Anonymous a hope for mankind, for we have established that man can live the life of the spirit and function effectively in a materialistic society.

In stepping down from this rostrum for the last time, I think in terms of profound gratitude to all of you who have provided me with the unique privilege of serving you as your Chairman. I have only one regret, and that is that I did not have the skill to do more than the little I have done to further the purposes of this great Society.

REPORT OF THE CONFERENCE SECRETARY

The Fifth Annual General Service Conference at St. Louis last Summer was an important milestone in the growing development of a responsible, representative Conference structure within the fellowship, Marian F., Conference Secretary reminded the Delegates. Acceptance by the 20th Anniversary Convention of a permanent charter for the Conference means that the future of A.A.'s "Third Legacy" of worldwide services rests largely with Delegates to this and future Conferences, Marian said.

During the period since the St. Louis meetings, Delegates were asked to advise Headquarters on sentiment in their areas on two separate proposals. (#15 and #16). The prompt and unanimously affirmative response enabled Headquarters to reflect movement-wide opinion on two important recommendations.

As a result, the Sixth Annual Conference became the first to admit a Delegate from an area outside the North American continent (Puerto Rico) and to welcome overseas observers from South Africa, Ireland, Norway and Holland.

In addition to the above two proposals, a third proposal consisting of five separate parts, was referred to the Delegates for detailed consideration in their areas prior to the convening of the Sixth Conference. (This proposal involved appraisal of the structure of the General Service Board, with specific reference to the ratio of non-alcoholic and alcoholic Trustees.)

An interesting development during the year was the fact that several Delegates consulted informally with Headquarters staff members on proposals tentatively scheduled to be presented during the Conference.

Many Delegates have contributed substantial time and effort in explaining the importance of Headquarters services to groups in their local areas. One result has been a gratifying increase in group contributions. It is still too early, however, to determine the full effect of the 1955 Conference decision to eliminate the special appeal for funds to help defray Conference costs.

TRUSTEES OF THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

One of the most important undertakings of the Board of Trustees during the past year was a searching reappraisal of its function as custodian of A.A. Tradition responsible for efficient operations of the movement's worldwide service agencies.

A practical result of this study was the creation and active functioning of three special committees (Finance and Budgetary, Policy, and Public Information, the latter a subcommittee of the Policy Committee). Many time-consuming matters which formerly were presented directly to the Board as a whole can now be reviewed and analyzed carefully before being presented to the Board with specific recommendations.

Thus the reports of these three new committees, on which the Board is represented, must be considered to obtain a true picture of the full scope of the Board's operations.

The following are some of the specific actions recorded by the Board since the last Conference. The Trustees:

1. Authorized A.A. Publishing, Inc. to negotiate a new agreement with trade distributors of the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous", severely restricting discounts allowed.
2. Authorized the distribution of the 1955 General Service Conference resolution on anonymity to over 6,500 sources in the United States and Canada such as newspapers, magazines, radio and TV stations, publishers, etc.
3. Agreed to accept no remuneration for out of pocket expenses in co-operating with a proposed TV broadcast. However, a film print may be accepted gratis for internal A.A. use.
4. Agreed to present to 1956 General Service Conference nominations for election to Board of Trustees as well as officers for the coming year.
5. Approved the request of A.A.'s in Finland for permission to translate material from the Big Book.
6. Approved the election of Richard A. Stevens as a Director of A.A. Publishing, Inc.

POLICY COMMITTEE

The Policy Committee was created by the General Service Board at the April, 1955, meeting to meet just prior to the Quarterly Board Meetings. Its function is to pass on all policy matters, presenting its findings in the form of recommendations to the Board. In cases of a strong minority opinion, both the majority and minority findings are reported. The Committee's report was presented by its Chairman, Cliff W.

Its membership is to consist of all out-of-town A.A. Trustees, the Senior Staff Members of General Service Headquarters, the Chairmen of A.A. Publishing, Inc. and the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The Chairman of the General Service Board shall also appoint not more than three additional members from the Board of Trustees.

Among the major matters considered during the past year were these: -

RECOMMENDATIONS

1. That the trademark symbol of a triangle within a circle, together with the words "General Service Conference," be restricted for use of Conference-approved literature only.

That the triangle within a circle, without wording, may be used anywhere by groups for use in banners, placards and similar displays.
2. That a sub-committee of the Policy Committee be created, called the Public Information Committee, to appraise and recommend public relations policy involving radio and TV, press, films, publications, etc. The activities of this subcommittee are to be guided by our policy of "attraction" rather than "promotion".
3. That General Service Headquarters Staff Members accept speaking invitations only from area functions and large meetings in which a majority of groups in the area have joined in extending the invitation. Furthermore, only one Staff Member is to accept from an area at one time.
4. That the proposed deluxe edition of the book, "Alcoholics Anonymous" be referred to the 1956 General Service Conference Delegates for their considered opinion.
5. That the recommendation of A.A. Publishing regarding a limitation on quoting from its publications by any source be approved and a restricting clause that reads as follows appear in all books and pamphlets as reprinted: "All rights reserved, but excerpts from this publication may be reproduced with the written permission of the publisher. For information, write to A.A. Publishing, Inc., P. O. Box 459, Grand Central Annex, New York 17, N. Y."
6. That any television or other production produced with our cooperation shall be subject to the approval of the Chairman of the Board as to the credit title. Any such credit given in the production shall not contain the words "endorsed" or "approved."
7. That the General Service Committee proceed to issue a combined monthly bulletin of General Service Headquarters news and services.

PUBLIC INFORMATION COMMITTEE

Creation of the Public Information Committee during the past year was a logical development in A.A.'s growth and was designed to fill two needs which have become increasingly demanding in recent years:

1. The need to prevent misunderstanding of our Fellowship, and the equal importance of creating increased understanding of our program.
2. The need, expressed by Bill, for broader sharing of responsibility in sustaining A.A.'s sound movement-wide public relations.

As a subcommittee of the Policy Committee, the "P.I.C." is an advisory group only. Its recommendations---when approved by the Policy Committee and the Trustees, are carried out as Service Headquarters activities. The Committee is further bound, in all public relations matters which it may consider, to adhere to the traditional A.A. policy of "attraction rather than promotion" in all public relationships.

Since its formation in January, 1956, the Public Information Committee has initiated the following projects:

1. Preparation of a basic "Fact File" on A.A. for distribution, upon request, to writers, editors and others in the fields of publishing, radio, television and motion pictures.
(While it has been possible to distribute standard A.A. literature in answer to requests from such sources in the past, up to now Headquarters has been handicapped by lack of basic material written, organized and produced for easy handling and filing by communications people. The "Fact File" is designed to fill this need.)
2. Revision and up-dating of the "pattern" newspaper stories and radio-television script material that has been used effectively by hundreds of local groups in the past.
3. Exploration of the possibility of developing a "general purpose" exhibit display on A.A. suitable for use at meetings of professional people in the fields of medicine, penology, law enforcement, public health and special service.
(A number of requests have been received for an exhibit of this type. Inability to provide one for important meetings and conferences costs A.A. an opportunity to describe the recovery program to many potential allies.)

The Committee submitted for the consideration of the Conference the following brief statement of "A.A.'s Movement-Wide Public Information Policy:"

"In all public relationships, A.A.'s sole objective is to help the still-suffering alcoholic. Always mindful of the importance of personal anonymity, we believe this can be done by making known to him, and to those who may be interested in his problem, our own experience as individuals and as a Fellowship in learning to live without alcohol. We believe that our experience should be made available freely to all who express sincere interest. We believe further that all our efforts in this field should always reflect our gratitude for the gift of sobriety and our awareness that many outside A.A. are equally concerned with the serious problem of alcoholism."

PUBLIC RELATIONS AND PUBLIC INFORMATION SERVICE

The 20th Anniversary Convention in St. Louis last Summer was an outstanding example of public relations and public information activities designed to create increased understanding of A.A., Lib S. reported. Key elements in this work included:

- A. Making review copies of the new edition of the Big Book available to leading reviewers throughout the country; a number of fine commentaries appeared in leading publications.
- B. Obtaining the telegram from President Eisenhower commending A.A.
- C. Working with newspapers, radio, television, wire services and feature syndicates who broadcast news of A.A.'s "coming of age" throughout the world.

In furtherance of A.A.'s basic public relations policy of "cooperation, but never affiliation," the following special assignments were handled by Headquarters personnel during the year:

- A. Bill's assistance to producers of DuPont's "One Day at a Time" TV show.
- B. Cooperation with the National Jail Association, providing material for mailing to 2,000 wardens and businessmen interested in better jails.
- C. Distribution of material to American Public Health Association.
- D. Revision of several magazine scripts submitted to office.
- E. Review of radio scripts and newspaper articles.
- F. Appearance of Headquarters staff members on local TV and radio shows.
- G. Referral (to Yale Clinic and National Committee on Alcoholism) of inquiries on establishing rehabilitation programs in industry.

As requested by the Fifth Conference, a special Conference resolution on anonymity was distributed to approximately 6,500 communications people in the U. S. and Canada under cover of a two-page letter from Mr. Bernard B. Smith, chairman of the General Service Board. Twenty-five categories of writers, editors, publishers and producers of radio, television and motion picture scripts were covered in this mailing, the largest of its kind in A.A. history. The anonymity resolutions was also sent to all A.A. groups, loners, Delegates and Committeemen.

During the twelve months ending April 1, 1956, 60 special letters calling attention to anonymity breaks were sent to newspaper and magazine editors and 33 letters were sent to A.A. members whose anonymity had been broken at the public level. Ten commercial establishments were asked to respect the A.A. Directory as a confidential document to be used only for A.A. purposes.

During the same period 1,239 inquiries were received and acknowledged. Of these, about half were from students in high schools, colleges, seminaries and schools of nursing. About 20 per cent were from non-alcoholics seeking help for a relative or friend and five percent were from alcoholics. The remainder came from doctors, clergymen, Armed Forces chaplains, hospital administrators, industrial nurses and from a variety of persons overseas. Overseas inquiries recently have averaged about ten per cent of the total received.

GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS OPERATIONS

The broad scope of General Service Headquarters operations during 1955 was indicated in the following data presented to the Delegates by Hank G., coordinating chairman of the Headquarters activity:

INCOMING MAIL ITEMS	35,128
(Inquiries, Group Communications, Contributions, etc.)	
OUTGOING MAIL ITEMS	135,348
(Including Monthly Bulletins)	
PACKAGES WRAPPED AND SHIPPED	20,196
(35,764 books, 497,292 pamphlets, 315 record sets and 193,098 wallet cards)	

The Accounting Department processed 8,602 orders for books, pamphlets, etc., and handled 6,341 contribution remittances.

Big Book - "Alcoholics Anonymous"

Sales of Original Edition from April 1939 through February 29, 1956	299,219
Sales of Revised Edition from July 1, 1955 through February 29, 1956	23,926

Book - "The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions"

Sales from May 1953 through February 29, 1956	44,578
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Distribution of Books, Pamphlets and Miscellaneous Items in 1955

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous (Old Edition) . . .	9,838
Alcoholics Anonymous (Revised Edition) .	19,015
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions . . .	6,805

Total Books Shipped. 36,568

Pamphlets

This is A.A.	76,926
A.A. - 44 Questions and Answers	60,726
Young People and A.A.	28,223
A.A. for the Woman	28,500
A.A. Tradition - How It Developed . . .	9,025
A.A. Traditions (Discontinued)	7,045
Sponsorship	22,977
Alcoholism the Illness	31,723
The Alcoholic Husband	38,404
The Alcoholic Wife	24,890
The Alcoholic Employee	15,237
A.A. and the Medical Profession	26,548
Sedatives and the Alcoholic	20,134
Saturday Evening Post Reprint	31,497
Fortune Reprint	23,884

Pamphlets (Continued)

Good Housekeeping Reprint . . .	25,418
Society of A.A. (Discontinued). . .	10,250
Medicine Looks at A.A. (Dis.) . . .	3,307
Third Legacy Pamphlet (Dis.) . . .	4,587
Third Legacy Manual	3,054
Pamphlets - (Translations) . . .	5,567

Total Pamphlets Shipped . . 497,292

Miscellaneous

Wallet Cards	193,098
Parchment Scrolls	657
Lasker Award Replicas	72
Books- A.A. - Spanish	106

Records

A.A.'s Traditions	41
Dr. Bob's Last Major Talk . . .	90
A.A.'s Three Legacies	61
Milestones Ahead	39
The Big Meeting (Discontinued). . .	84

Total Record Sets Shipped . . 315

FINANCE & BUDGETARY COMMITTEE REPORT

Basic financial data on 1955 Headquarters operations was presented to the Delegates by Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board and Chairman of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Two innovations in financial reporting for A.A.'s service agencies were introduced this year.

In addition to detailed certified audits of all operations, Delegates also received a special simplified financial statement and an estimated budget for 1956 for General Service Headquarters, A.A. Publishing, Inc., and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

In his comments on the figures as they were presented, Mr. Roosevelt made the following points:

1. Expenses of the 1956 Conference are being paid in part, to the extent of \$12,500, from 1955 group contributions over and above Headquarters expenses. This is in accordance with the action of the Fifth General Service Conference which requested that the separate fund appeal for each annual Conference be discontinued.
2. From July 1, 1954, until the Fifth Annual Conference (June 26-July 3) last year, groups had waived book discounts in order to permit accumulation of a prudent reserve for future Headquarters operations. From this source the amount of \$9,181 for 1954 and \$19,335 for 1955 was allocated to the Reserve Fund. At the St. Louis Conference, this arrangement was amended by the Delegates so that the groups thereafter waived only half of their discounts. Based on 1956 estimated book sales, only \$13,750 will be added to the Reserve Fund in 1956.
3. Contributions during 1955 totalled \$135,000, an increase of \$18,000 over contributions in 1954. The 1956 budget is based on this rate of increase.
4. "While optimism is justified, we must never be satisfied with ourselves until every group in the United States and Canada has the opportunity to contribute. (Meantime) any additional expenditures should not be considered unless the wherewithal to pay the additional cost can be foreseen."

1956 HEADQUARTERS BUDGET

Following is the budget covering 1956 operations of General Service Headquarters agencies, as presented to the Delegates by Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer of the General Service Board and Chairman of Finance and Budgetary Committee:

ESTIMATED CONTRIBUTIONS, GROSS PROFITS, AND OPERATING EXPENSES

	<u>Receipts</u>	<u>Expenses</u>	<u>Net Income</u>	<u>Net (Deficit)</u>
General Service Headquarters.... (Contributions)	\$152,000	\$162,500 *		(\$10,500)
A.A. Publishing, Inc. (Gross Profit)	92,500 **	76,000	16,500	
A.A. Grapevine, Inc. (Gross Profit)	57,000	55,000	2,000	
General Service Board.....		15,700		(15,700)
 TOTALS	 <u>\$301,500</u>	 <u>\$309,200</u>	 <u>\$18,500</u>	 <u>(\$26,200)</u>

NET ESTIMATED DEFICIT -- (\$7,700) ***

* Including Cost of General Service Conference \$17,500

** Based Upon Sales of - 25,000 books "Alcoholics Anonymous"
(Total income less 5,000 " "12 Steps and 12 Traditions"
printing & royalty expense) Averaged - Pamphlets & Miscellaneous

*** Exclusive of Reserve Fund Appreciation of 17,000
(from Book Discounts and Interest)

GROUP RELATIONS

Although contact between Service Headquarters and A.A.'s more than 6,000 groups worldwide is at an all-time high, the need for strengthening this relationship continues to be a serious problem, Ann M. of the Headquarters staff told the Delegates.

Only 2,929 of the 5,184 groups in the U.S. and Canada returned registration cards for the 1956 Directory, Ann noted. Since "old" registration data must be used when no card is returned by a group, the Directory of necessity is less accurate and useful than it should be.

Accurate group records are the key to effective Headquarters service to groups, Ann pointed out. An estimated 19,000 changes are required annually to keep listings current. In 1955, 838 new groups were registered; each registration involved ten separate clerical operations. In the same period 454 groups were inactivated and removed from listings, following a series of checks over a two-year period.

Based on continuing experience, there is a need for improvement in the matter of bringing Headquarters bulletins and other material to the attention of group members. This is being done effectively by General Service Representatives in some groups but in many areas the G.S.R. procedures have not yet been adopted or have collapsed. (More than 1,500 groups have not adopted the G.S.R. plan to date.)

General Service Representatives have been selected by 3,216 groups in the U.S. and Canada but only 2,640 are listed with Headquarters, since many receive mail through Group Secretaries.

A disturbing development has been the sharp reduction in use of Group P.O. Boxes. (P. O. Box listing not only simplifies record-keeping at Headquarters but also provides an "anonymous" address for an inquirer.) Indicating the lack of uniformity in group addresses, Headquarters mail is now going to 1,999 G.S.R.s at home addresses, to 829 in care of box numbers, to 229 in care of the Group Secretary, to 159 in care of other addresses (club rooms, Intergroup offices, meeting places, etc.), to 641 Secretaries in care of box numbers and to 171 secretaries in care of miscellaneous addresses. Increased uniformity of group mailing addresses would be desirable from the viewpoint of Headquarters economy and to assure better service to the groups.

Interesting A.A. trends worldwide were revealed in the following figures: As of April 1, 1956, 30 Armed Forces Groups were registered at Headquarters, 8 Twelfth Step Houses, 97 Women's Groups, 36 Young People's Groups and 107 Intergroups. The growing interest in "specialized" units is suggested by the fact that the number of Women's and Young People's Groups have increased substantially during the past year.

Group problems most frequently brought to the attention of Headquarters personnel are related to club houses, Twelfth Step facilities, qualifications for membership, Intergroup operations, group finances and community relations, Ann reported.

INSTITUTIONAL GROUPS (PRISONS AND HOSPITALS)

As of April 1, 1956, according to General Service Headquarters registrations, there were 290 institutional (prison) A.A. groups with a total membership of 13,056 members in 48 states, 7 Canadian provinces and 10 other countries, Hazel R. reported to the Delegates. This represented an increase of 31 over the 259 groups registered a year earlier.

Hospital groups served by Headquarters on April 1 totalled 211 with a membership of 4,952 men and women in 40 states, four provinces of Canada and eight other countries. Twenty-two new hospital groups were added during the year.

Two significant trends in institutional A.A. were noted during the past year.

First was the accumulating evidence that A.A.'s Traditions are increasingly being used as guides by groups in correctional institutions. Analysis of questionnaires returned during a recent survey of prison group practices showed that nearly nine out of every ten groups responding in the study are attempting to follow basic A.A. Tradition. In this connection it was noted that nearly all groups will admit to membership any inmate who expresses a sincere desire to join. Questionnaires were returned by approximately one-third of the prison groups.

The second significant trend was the growth of "outside A.A." interest in sponsoring the recovery program in institutions. Many local groups reported formation of new "institutional committees" to work with inmates and patients. Statewide sponsorship programs are expanding. More and more A.A.s individually, and through groups, are taking an interest in the rehabilitation problems of the "Skid Row" alcoholic. An increasing number of institutional administrators are inviting local groups (directly or through Service Headquarters) to explain the A.A. recovery program and assist in sponsoring new institutional groups.

A.A. therapy appears to be an accepted part of the broad picture of institutional rehabilitative work in the U.S. and Canada, with many indications that this acceptance is growing in the U.S. Armed Forces and in Great Britain and Australia.

A new feature of Headquarters service to institutional groups during the past year was the development of special, printed "Exchange Bulletins" circulated to both prison and hospital units on a bi-monthly basis. The bulletins are based almost exclusively on material submitted by the groups themselves. To provide greater frequency of contact with all institutional groups, material which formerly appeared in these publications will in the future be included in the new "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" distributed to all groups for the first time during May.

Delegates were urged to advise Headquarters of the formation of new groups in the institutional field and to report personal experiences in working with them.

Growth has been the dominant characteristic of A.A. overseas during the past year, Eve M. of the Headquarters staff, reported. Two aspects of this growth deserve emphasis, Eve pointed out: (1) The fact of A.A.'s numerical growth overseas in countries of varying cultures, and (2) The increasing reliance of "older" overseas groups on A.A.'s basic Traditions.

Headquarters records show that in 1946 there were only ten groups outside the U.S. and Canada, with a total membership of 250. Today, ten years later, there are 564 groups with a membership of 14,278.

During 1955 alone 123 new groups were formed overseas and 47 additional lone members were registered. Combined, they purchased 5,567 assorted pamphlets in the six translations available and 106 copies of the Spanish edition of the Big Book.

The evolution of A.A. as a stable movement overseas is suggested by the fact that, according to conservative estimates, three out of four lone members are eventually successful in establishing a group in their community.

Registration of new groups and lone members in Egypt, San Salvador, Portugal, the Netherlands Antilles and Chile during the past year indicate that the A.A. message is continuing to spread and that the recovery program can serve the alcoholic in any culture. The formation of "native" groups in such countries as France and Spain, where heretofore A.A. membership has consisted mainly of expatriate Americans and Englishmen, has been particularly encouraging.

It was apparent during 1955 that in such areas as Australia, Africa, England, Finland and Norway, where A.A. has been functioning for a number of years, an increased awareness of the value of A.A.'s Traditions was developing. Many of these older overseas groups have been experiencing problems common to most North American groups during their early growth stages: problems relating to money, acceptance of outside contributions, anonymity, relations with other agencies interested in alcoholism as a social problem, establishment of Intergroup or Central Offices and similar questions.

In practically every case where "the first tendency" was to deviate from the Traditions on the grounds that they were not suited to local needs, increased group maturity has resulted in recognition that these guides to group survival can be applied effectively in any part of the world.

A significant part of A.A. overseas activity currently involves the U.S. Armed Forces. A total of 53 registrations of groups and lone members are recorded at Headquarters. They represent A.A. facilities in France, Germany, Alaska, Bermuda, Greenland, Puerto Rico, Guam, Formosa, Korea, the Philippines and Japan.

LITERATURE COMMITTEE

Headquarters editorial facilities were utilized extensively during the St. Louis Convention, Cal McC., Trustee, noted in his portion of the literature Committee report. Advance contacts were made with newspapers, wire services and radio and television stations in St. Louis; a special "press room" was maintained throughout the Convention. More than a score of news and feature releases were prepared during the meeting in accordance with requests from the local press.

Three daily "Convention Bulletins" were prepared and distributed and special material was prepared for, and used by, two national radio networks. The St. Louis activity had been preceded by several months of planning and preparation that included production of special folders, the official Convention program and related material.

To get maximum editorial attention for the new edition of the Big Book, review copies were distributed to a carefully-selected list of approximately 200 leading reviewers throughout the U.S. and Canada. A basic memorandum on the history and significance of A.A.'s principal text was distributed for the guidance of reviewers.

During the year three new folders were produced, as requested by the Fifth Conference: (1) a folder on the General Service Representative plan, based on an extract from the Third Legacy Manual; (2) An introductory folder, "Is A.A. For You?" priced at five cents; (3) a new version of "Your Role in the General Service Conference."

Editorial material in the "Handbook and Directory" was up-dated and two pamphlets were re-issued in the new "slim" format: (1) "Sedatives and the Alcoholic" and "Young People and A.A."

Special four-page, printed "Exchange Bulletins" were designed, edited and produced for distribution to Lone members, Internationalists and groups in prisons and hospitals. Material which has appeared to date in these Bulletins will henceforth be contained in the new "A.A. Exchange Bulletin".

The Literature Committee submitted the following question for the consideration of the Conference:

"Shall a deluxe edition of the book, 'Alcoholics Anonymous' be made available in a leather binding and individually packaged, to be priced at \$7.50, with a discount to the groups of fifty cents, with an additional fifty cents to be earmarked for the Reserve Fund?"

The Conference agreed that this proposal should be reconsidered at the 1957 Conference. (See page 45.)

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

Summaries of 1955 operations of The A.A. Grapevine were presented to the Conference by Russ C., Secretary-Treasurer, and Don G., Chairman and Editor. Both reports emphasized the substantial progress made by the Society's international monthly journal during the past year.

From the standpoint of circulation, Russ told the Delegates, 1955 was the magazine's best year since 1951. Circulation rose 3,000 copies, more than twice the increase of the two preceding years.

During a special circulation effort following the St. Louis Conference and Convention, 774 "new" groups placed bulk orders. Prior to the St. Louis meetings 70 percent of the groups in the United States and Canada did not place bulk orders. This figure has now been lowered to 57 percent.

It was pointed out that, with current operating expenses at approximately \$9,000 per month, The Grapevine's present earning potential is only about \$4,000 annually, considered inadequate to assure financial stability for a truly representative journal. "The Grapevine has no reserve fund of any consequence at the present time."

Delegates are being asked to form "Grapevine committees" in each General Service area, Russ said. In each area personal contact with the groups will be a key objective in an effort to boost circulation to 40,000 by 1957. Circulation at this level would provide about \$14,000 income after expenses annually, making it possible to develop a reserve fund. Total circulation as of April 1, 1956, was 35,000 copies monthly.

A recent "pilot" circulation effort in an Eastern area was reviewed with the Delegates. The test, which featured systematic personal contacts with the groups, indicated that thousands of potential subscribers exist throughout the U. S. and Canada alone, Russ suggested.

In his report on editorial operations of the magazine, Don G. urged Delegates to stimulate members in their areas to contribute material for consideration by Grapevine editors.

He also emphasized the importance of the Grapevine's role in backgrounding "A.A. therapy" in community groups, prison and hospital units and among lone members and internationalists.

CONFERENCE ACTIONS ON STAFF REPORTS

Digests of all Headquarters staff and committee reports were made available to all Delegates when they registered. Following verbal presentation of these reports a session was set aside specifically for Conference discussion of the reports and recommendations and suggestions contained therein. Following is a summary of Conference actions in accepting all reports:

Report on the Conference

Agreed that ex-Delegates should be kept on the Conference mailing list for a period of ten years following completion of service.

Public Information Committee Report

Approved the proposed statement of "A.A.'s Movement-Wide Public Information Policy." (See page 18.)

Report on Group Relations

Conceding the seriousness of the problem caused by lack of uniformity in group mailing addresses, Conference agreed no policy "directives" should be issued. Urged the Policy Committee to explore this problem. Expressed faith that G.S. Representatives could be increasingly helpful in keeping Headquarters advised of changes of group addresses.

Report on Public Information and Public Relations Service

Approved the new Headquarters policy of granting permission to quote from A.A. literature upon receipt of specific requests, following appraisal of the merits of individual requests.

Report on Foreign Relations

Agreed that qualified "observers" from overseas areas be admitted to the 1957 Conference. Referred to the Committee on Policy (See page 44) the question of whether 1956 "observers" should be placed on the Conference mailing list.

Report on Service to Institutions

Agreed that inquiries from institutions should initially be referred to an Intergroup office, if one is active in the area involved, and to the Area Delegate. If no acknowledgement is received from these contacts within two weeks, G.S.H. is to use its own best judgment in referring the inquiry to a local group.

Report of Literature Committee

Suggested that the new "A.A. Exchange Bulletin" be made available in quantity to groups wishing to purchase additional copies and agreed that Bulletin distribution should be exclusively through local groups or service offices.

Report of The A.A. Grapevine

After discussing possible future need for price increase, asked that quarterly financial and circulation reports be made available to Delegates.

PRESENT RATIO OF TRUSTEES IS RETAINED UNTIL 1958
"ROTATION" OF CONFERENCE LOCATIONS IS TABLED

(Proposal 14-a)

At the Fifth Annual Conference in St. Louis, it was agreed that proposed changes in the ratio of non-alcoholics to alcoholics on the Board of Trustees be considered at the 1956 Conference.

Accordingly, five alternate proposals were submitted to Delegates for area review and analysis in December, 1955.

Discussion of the proposed changes was preceded by brief comments by Chairman Bernard Smith and Bill. Citing 14 years experience on the Board, Mr. Smith noted that the Trustees had never split along "alcoholic versus non-alcoholic" lines. Bill pointed out the great contributions non-alcoholic Trustees have made to A.A.'s growth but reminded Delegates that they should be objective in considering the movement's present and possible future needs.

After a number of Delegates had paid warm tributes to A.A.'s non-alcoholic Trustees, the Conference adopted unanimously the proposal that:

The current structure of the Board of Trustees, comprising a total of fifteen members, of whom eight are non-alcoholics, should be retained.

Subsequently the Conference asked the General Service Board to "give this subject further thought" and place it on the agenda of the 1957 Conference so that a specific proposal can be relayed to the groups with the understanding that no Conference action will be sought until 1958.

(Proposal # 17)

Delegates had been advised in November, 1955, that a proposal had been made that meetings of the General Service Conference should be "rotated" each year. Under this proposal, Conference meetings would be held in New York City in "even" years and rotated from one geographical section to another in "odd" years.

The Delegate who had originated the proposal suggested that adoption of the policy would be helpful in marshalling increased movement support in behalf of A.A.'s headquarters service agencies.

Other Delegates cited the increased cost that would be involved in such a proposal and expressed the belief that the benefits to be derived would not warrant the expense and disruption of Headquarters operations.

After hearing a clear expression of both viewpoints, the Delegates voted unanimously that this proposal be tabled for consideration at some future date.

CALIFORNIA BID FOR "NEXT CONVENTION" SUPPORTED
NO DECISION ON RESTRICTED ADVERTISING POLICY

(Proposal # 18)

Northern California Group Representatives last September asked that the 1956 Conference approve a proposal that anniversary conventions of A.A. be held every two years, that the location be shifted geographically to permit a maximum number of members to attend and that a 1957 Convention be held "somewhere in California."

Several Delegates from California directed attention to the potential support for such a Convention in their State and expressed the belief that Convention costs could be underwritten by a host area.

During the discussion it was explained to the Delegates that Bill and Lois might not be able to attend the type of meeting proposed and that this fact might have a bearing on local area support.

On a voice vote, the proposal was defeated overwhelmingly.

Later in the same Conference session, however, following a stirring comment by one of the California Delegates, the Conference voted unanimously to recommend to the General Service Board that the next A.A. movement-wide Convention be held in California. It was understood that the privilege of determining the date, circumstances and other details of such a convention was reserved to the Trustees.

(Proposal # 19)

The Conference was asked for guidance in determining whether or not it should be considered contrary to A.A. Tradition and policy for the General Service Board to approve advertising describing A.A. literature in any media. This proposal also provided that the right of groups to determine local information policies should remain a matter of local autonomy.

It quickly became evident that the Conference was not of one mind concerning this proposal. Several Delegates were eloquent in their suggestion that this form of "carrying the message" would be beneficial to A.A. Others appeared equally certain that adoption of the proposal would harm the movement's public relations and might be misunderstood by both alcoholics and non-alcoholics.

A motion to table the proposal was accepted graciously by exponents of both viewpoints and adopted unanimously.

POLICY TOWARD TELEVISION AND MOTION PICTURES

One of the longest policy sessions of the Conference centered on recommendations covering movement policy as a guide to Headquarters personnel in their relationships with television and motion picture producers. Prior to formal voting Mr. Bernard Smith and Bill reviewed several projects in these media that have been presented to the Board since the last Conference.

After full discussion of the problem, the following resolutions were adopted unanimously:

- #1. The Conference approves the concept of having the General Service Board of A.A. arrange, if it can, for the production of a network television program, or programs, relating to the story and work of A.A., provided that the General Service Board has the right of script approval and that such script, before it is approved, is approved both by Bill and the Public Information Committee, which is a subcommittee of the Policy Committee.

- #2. This North American Conference authorizes the General Service Board to permit the use of the words, "made in cooperation with Alcoholics Anonymous," or words of similar import, only in the case where either the General Service Board or any of its Committees or the A.A. Publishing Company, have right of script approval. In all other cases no type of indication that it is made in cooperation with A.A. shall be permitted. When General Service Headquarters is approached for assistance or information in relation to the production of a motion picture or television program or a radio program and publications and all other media of communications, the matter shall be referred to the Policy Committee or the Public Information Committee and they shall determine under what circumstances they are prepared to provide assistance to producers, for the basic purpose of insuring that, so far as possible, A.A. is not misinterpreted in any such projects.

- #3. In keeping with the Fourth Tradition which provides that each group shall be autonomous except in matters affecting other groups or Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, it is suggested to all groups by the North American Conference that the groups submit to the Policy Committee of the General Service Board of A.A. or to its Public Information Committee all proposals relating to Alcoholics Anonymous respecting motion pictures, television programs, network radio programs, and magazines and newspapers of national circulation. However, in keeping with the concept of local autonomy in public relations it is understood that cooperation with respect to a local television program might be given, provided no proprietary right is granted in, and to, the material provided or in a title in which the name Alcoholics Anonymous forms a part with respect to such television program.

POLICY ON ACCEPTANCE OF OUT-OF-POCKET EXPENSE MONEY
REPORT ON OKLAHOMA BIRTHDAY PLAN
CHANGE IN DATE OF ANNUAL MEETING OF TRUSTEES

In a special session Sunday morning, scheduled because it had proved impossible to cover the full agenda in detail at the close of the regular sessions Saturday afternoon, Delegates undertook to reach a meeting of minds on several important policy matters.

Following extensive discussion in which varying viewpoints were presented, the following motion was adopted by a substantial majority:

"As a temporary policy until we have more experience, if, in the judgment of the General Service Board of A.A. and its Committees who are delegated specific powers with respect thereto, it should appear possible to secure actual reimbursement for out-of-pocket expenses, they are free to accept same with respect to a sponsored television program or a motion picture, with the understanding that this is only suggested policy and does not constitute a policy that shall be deemed binding in any fashion on future Conferences."

It was also agreed that Bill and any appropriate G.S.B. committee should have the right to request a print or negative, or whatever form of print can be used for duplicating purposes, with A.A. paying the cost of duplication for the benefit of groups within North America and, if possible, for extra-territorial exhibition.

The Delegate from Oklahoma reported on the success of the "Birthday Plan" in his area, where the plan originated. He noted that it had been helpful in "bringing back" 35 to 40 old-timers who were now taking a more active interest in group affairs and that it had made it possible to double the State's contributions to G.S.H. He acknowledged that variations on the Plan might be desirable in other areas and offered to make available letters and other materials used in Oklahoma. It was agreed by several Delegates with experience in establishing the Plan that it should function through the groups and that participants should be encouraged to make their gifts to the groups, for transmittal (in total) to G.S.H.

After brief discussion, the Conference approved the suggestion that the date of the annual meeting of the Board of Trustees be changed from January to April, immediately following the Conference, to assure more efficient handling of movement-wide affairs.

HOW TWO DELEGATES REPORTED CONFERENCE ACTIVITIES TO THEIR AREAS

Delegates from San Francisco, California, and Ontario, Canada, took part in a special panel presentation in which they described methods used to report the "Third Legacy Story" back to their Areas:

San Francisco

Delegate serves 130 groups, of which 120 have appointed General Service Representatives. He works with a Committeeman in each of 18 districts. Area publication, "Good News," always carries some reference to Third Legacy services. Effective liaison is maintained with Delegates from adjacent areas.

Committeemen meet every two months. Delegate reports to Committeemen who, in turn, carry reports back to local groups. Delegate meets with local groups only on invitation. Interim contact with groups is achieved with a monthly bulletin from Committee. November bulletin, for example, urges groups to cooperate by getting registration cards back to G.S.H. as soon as possible. Conference report is digested for distribution to G.S.R.s. "You and Your Third Legacy" leaflet is used to explain importance of support for A.A.'s worldwide services.

Delegate secured from Headquarters a breakdown showing contributions by groups in his area up to a certain date. Each Committeeman then received specific figures for his area.

Suggestion was made that Thanksgiving Week be known as "Gratitude Week" in A.A. and that Delegates assume greater responsibility for getting accurate group records to Headquarters staff.

Ontario, Canada

Upon returning to Province, Delegate calls a meeting at Toronto on a Sunday, with expenses paid by the Ontario Committee. Later he attends Ontario Regional Conference at Toronto, which normally attracts 2,000 A.A.'s, including G.S.R.'s from Ontario and groups in nearby U.S. communities. Also attends Eastern and Western Ontario Conferences held in Ottawa and London respectively. Panels on general services are on the programme at all Conferences."

Bringing Headquarters people to Conferences as speakers has proved effective way of supplementing Delegate's report and has also proved "good public relations."

Delegate seeks to impress on his Committeemen importance of attending groups when anniversaries or other "special events" occur. Delegate himself visits many groups informally, is usually recognized and given opportunity to speak on services. Committee uses publication, "All Around Ontario" to help carry Conference message. In his talks, Delegate tries to give listeners a capsule description of reports heard and actions taken at Conferences, emphasizing theme: "Big business? No! Important business? Yes!"

ORGANIZATION OF AREA COMMITTEES AND THEIR ACTIVITIES

Delegates from East Texas, Florida, Central Michigan, Arkansas, Washington and Eastern Pennsylvania participated in a panel that produced a number of specific ideas and viewpoints that have been successful in getting increased support for A.A.'s Third Legacy throughout the movement.

Following are brief highlights from the various presentations:

East Texas

Program has been in operation since 1951, based on dividing area into 10 sections, each with Committeeman. Number of groups covered increased from 54 to 60 during year. Emphasis is on "exploring" A.A., not analyzing it.

Fourteen meetings held during past year, with attendance ranging from 35 to 175. Excellent support from Area Committee: never less than seven Committeemen at a meeting. It is considered important to inform the Committeemen and G.S.R.'s on Headquarters services. For example, all receive complete packets of literature. Final Reports of Conference are distributed widely within Conference structure. At each meeting, care is taken to review status of groups. As a result, four or five "shaky" groups have been helped, a few new ones have been established.

To assure continuity, ex-Delegate becomes chairman of Area Committee. Success of over-all program suggested by fact that contributions nearly doubled.

Central Michigan

Original districting of State was revised to correct A.A. population change. Meetings have increased from two or three a year to monthly, rotated to stimulate interest in particular sections. July, 1955, Grapevine article by Bill on the Third Legacy as the "Heart of A.A. World Service" has been used effectively to inform Committeemen and G.S.R.'s. Number of groups covered has increased from eight to 30 in five years.

Main purpose of all activity is always "perpetuation of A.A." All groups receive minutes of Council (Area Committee) meetings but are reminded that Third Legacy and local concerns should be handled separately.

Council has sponsored a number of special projects: (1) Special Conference meeting in Lansing, (2) Provision of G.S.H. literature packages for inmates at Southern Michigan State Prison and (3) Introduction of recovery program in new prison camp. As awareness has grown, fund-raising problems have decreased.

Arkansas

"Best way to get the Third Legacy idea across is to display your wares." Birthday Plan, based on State experience, seems to be step toward solution of problem of getting adequate support for worldwide services. Delegate added personal letter to last Fall's fund letters, copy sent to all Committeemen, G.S.R.'s. As a result 25 letters netted \$270.

ORGANIZATION OF AREA COMMITTEES AND THEIR ACTIVITIES(Continued)

Arkansas (Continued)

At intervals a card is sent to all groups asking for up-to-date information on active members, inactive members, probable amount of contributions and changes in address, if any. Season between Thanksgiving and Christmas have proved most fruitful in seeking financial support. Delegate uses photostats of contribution checks to document story of interest in Third Legacy.

One large meeting held each year in Arkansas, plus two Assemblies and 30 to 40 smaller meetings.

Washington State

Until three years ago Conference set-up in State had been "hazy." Now 87 groups covered, including two nearby Canadian groups. State maps, sent to all groups, show location of existing groups and communities where new groups are likely to be set up. When 25% of letters in Delegate's first mailing to groups were returned, prison group was asked to help survey A.A. situation in state by printing and arranging to distribute a special questionnaire. As a result, State Directory now much more accurate.

Monthly report goes to all groups. Delegate tours State, making personal reports, provides tape recordings for groups which he is unable to cover or which want to hear Conference story a second time. Institutional Committee and A.A. Newspaper Committee have been set up. Series of 30 cartoons have been put on slides for use in presenting story. Delegate also writes personal letter to groups from N.Y. during Conference. Uses mail heavily during year, as many as 120 letters a month, many including 15 to 20 pages of background material.

Eastern Pennsylvania

Starting "from scratch," nine areas, each with Committeeman, were set up. Now trying to hold maximum number of groups in each area to about 15. One Fall meeting held each year, also one Spring meeting designed to make areas "Third Legacy conscious." Co-operation from Intergroup has been fine. Delegate attended meetings of 72 of 96 groups in area at 32 meetings, was surprised to learn how many "old timers" became interested in Third Legacy.

Committee Financing is based on "telling groups what the money is for" and involves getting \$5. from each group. At larger meetings, names of groups and their contributions are listed on blackboard (as is done in other areas.) Contributions have increased about 18% but still not considered adequate. Agreed that State map and Directory are worth the hard work required. Importance of using attention-getting devices in presentations was emphasized.

"AREA DELEGATES ONLY" MEETING

As is customary at General Service Conferences, one entire session was set aside for deliberations of Delegates from the various Conference Areas. Trustees, Headquarters staff personnel and others are excluded from these "closed" sessions.

At their Area Delegates' meeting, the 1956 representatives adopted the following resolutions for presentation to the full Conference:

1. The Delegates endorse and commend Bill's latest writing project which is to be known as a preliminary history of A.A. (or by a similar name which may be selected later) and recommend that this book be published in a first class manner and that said publication include pictures or other appropriate material and that the final sales price be determined by the General Service Board. (See Literature Committee report, page 45.)
2. The Delegates of the 1956 General Service Conference accept on a voluntary basis the responsibility of establishing a Grapevine committee in their respective areas for the purpose of increasing the sales of the magazine. (See Grapevine Committee report, page 46.)
3. The Chairman of the General Service Board, Mr. Bernard B. Smith, is asked to consider, and give the Delegates his interpretation of, the intent and meaning of Paragraph Seven of Page 53 of The Third Legacy Manual of A.A. World Service in the Section on "The Conference Panels."

(The paragraph follows:

"At some future time, it may be desirable to create another elected Panel for the Conference. Those Delegates now named in Panels One and Two on account of extra population can then be moved into a third Panel. This could give the General Service Conference a greater continuity through a three-year term of service for Delegates.")

At Mr. Smith's request, Bill explained that this paragraph is intended to indicate the flexibility of the Conference structure and to permit certain specific changes, if the need arises.

4. (Proposed for reference to the Committee on Admissions:)

On account of the increase in A.A. population in Panel One, Los Angeles, California area, it is requested that the Committee on Admissions consider the advisability of selecting another Delegate from that particular area. (See Admissions Committee report, page 42.)

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

It has become Traditional at General Service Conference to afford Delegates the widest latitude (and complete anonymity, if desired) in asking any question pertaining to operations of A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies and the Conference structure itself. A question box is available to Delegates and its contents are read to the Conference at intervals. The following indicates the scope of questions asked during the 1956 Conference and the disposition of each query:

<u>Question</u>	<u>Disposition</u>
1. How can "old-timers" be induced to retain an active interest in group affairs?	Delegates from several areas reported that "giving the old-timers something to do" appeared to be the key to solution of this problem. This question also was referred to Literature Committee and Grapevine editors.
2. What is the status of Hank G. who presided at Conference sessions in absence of Chairman of G.S.B.?	Hank serves as vice-chairman of the Conference by virtue of his post as Chairman of Headquarters General Service Committee. The 1953 Conference itself confirmed that Board Chairman should be Chairman of Conference, that Service Committee Chairman should be vice-chairman and that a staff member should be secretary.
3. Should local groups handle requests from High Schools for speakers or should inquiries of this type be referred elsewhere?	Delegates reported that some groups send "youngest members" who volunteer for such assignments. Older members who do not have children in the school also are helpful. Occasionally, inquiries are referred elsewhere.
4. How can ex-Delegates be used effectively within Conference structure?	Some areas make ex-Delegates members or Chairmen of area committees.
5. What's the best procedure when an area committeeman won't work?	In one area, Delegate or Committee Chairman keeps in touch with local groups, asks them to advise whether or not committeeman is serving well. Procedure usually leads to resignation of ineffectual committeemen.
6. Does Bill serve the Trustees in an advisory capacity?	Yes. It is hoped that he will be able to do so for many years to come.

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

(Continued)

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| 7. What is the best local election procedure for selecting Conference people? | Agreed that this is a matter for individual area to determine after referring to Third Legacy Manual. |
| 8. Are copies of certificates of incorporation and by-laws of A.A.'s service agencies available for examination by Delegates? | Yes. (This material was made available immediately following the session to the interested Delegate). Mr. Smith also noted that present by-laws are somewhat out-of-date because of numerous amendments to them over the years. He said a new set of by-laws will be prepared during coming year, and made available to all Delegates. |
| 9. Should ex-Delegates be entitled to receive from G.S.H. figures on current contributions from an Area? | Question was prompted by a specific incident. Following explanation of circumstances, it was agreed ex-Delegates should be entitled to such information only when request was endorsed or confirmed by the Area Committee. |
| 10. Why not make Delegates responsible for prompt return of group registration cards for Directory? | Experience shows that, because of inevitable delays, it would not be practical to have G.S.H. write to Delegates to obtain data from unresponsive groups. Nor would it be practical to have a professional firm compile the Directory. G.S.H. will welcome cooperation of Delegates in urging local groups to return cards promptly---and legibly. |
| 11. How does the Conference regard the anonymity breaks of the author of the book and film: "I'll Cry Tomorrow?" | Agreed that it was unfortunate. |
| 12. Can the old "A.A." pamphlet be revived? | Referred to Literature Committee. |
| 13. Is it considered a violation of Tradition when a wife, who is a member of Family Groups and who accompanies Delegate husband to N.Y., reports to local Family Groups on her return to Delegate's home area? | Agreed that no violation was involved. |

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

(Continued)

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| 14. Can the dust jacket on the new edition of the Big Book be restyled in the red-and-yellow of the first edition? | Agreed that present jacket has been well-received. (Bill had been authorized to use own judgment in selection of design and color for new jacket.) |
| 15. Has more than one area been asked by a Church group to cooperate in promoting local radio use of a recorded program series on A.A.? | Discussion revealed this was the case. (G.S.H. has protested use of Directory for mail campaign, while recognizing helpful intent of program sponsor.) |
| 16. Would it be feasible to issue a 35-cent reprint of the Big Book? | It was noted that this question has been raised several times in past Conferences, and that the matter had been given serious consideration for many years. The most compelling reason why such a proposal is not practicable is suggested by the fact that so-called "book profits" have, many times in the past, been responsible for survival of Headquarters office when group contributions did not equal expenses. |
| 17. Would it be desirable to have a "pattern release," for Delegates to issue locally on return to their home areas, citing basic data and pertinent statistics on A.A.? | After careful review, it was agreed that this was a matter of local autonomy and that for the present it appeared desirable for G.S.H. to avoid "canned" releases. |
| 18. Why doesn't G.S.H. make available to local groups information on how to set up local plans for hospitalizing alcoholics? | G.S.H. never presumes to tell a group, much less a hospital, how a plan of this type should be established. G.S.H. does however, upon request, provide data on the experience of a noted hospital in New York City and also provides the names of other hospitals known to have similar plans. In addition, the Handbook distributed to all groups contains a full page on "Hospitalization," including a basic checklist for a hospital plan. |
| 19. Should steps be taken to establish A.A.'s famous "24th Street Clubhouse" in New York City as an A.A. shrine? | After discussion, it was agreed that this was a matter for local, rather than movement-wide, consideration. |
| 20. It is not clear that Bill has voting status in the Conference. What are the facts? | The Conference Charter adopted at St. Louis provides that Bill shall always have voting status in A.A. Conferences. |

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

(Continued)

21. Could a stamped envelope be sent out with fund appeal letters?
- This has been tried and has not proved practical. However, use of a self-addressed return envelope will be tried next Fall and results reported to the '57 Conference.
22. Why was there such a small turnout at the St. Louis convention, compared with figures for the Cleveland convention in 1950?
- It was pointed out that Cleveland attendance figures, as published, were not realistic, hence comparison not fully valid. Delegates agreed another big A.A. meeting in another section might have been a factor and it was noted that St. Louis itself does not have the same size A.A. population as the Cleveland-Akron area.
23. Has provision been made for Lois in the event of Bill's loss?
- Noting that earlier Conferences had expressed same interest, for which he and Lois were most grateful, Bill said that Trustees had approved arrangement whereby royalties on his books for the movement would go to Lois if he were not on hand during her full life span.
24. Should G.S.R. be replaced when he becomes a Committeeman?
- Comments from floor indicated that this was a matter for local autonomy. In some areas, Conference workers are replaced as they are selected for more demanding jobs. Bill noted that flexibility on such matters had been written into the Third Legacy Manual, the only firm suggestion being that Delegates should not succeed themselves.
25. Why do Staff members have votes in Conference, on Conference committees, and whom do they represent?
- It was pointed out that this procedure had been approved in previous Conferences. As to whom they represent, Bill commented that they represent great and valuable experience and that it would not make sense to develop "classes" of A.A. workers in which the experienced people would be deprived of votes. In practice, Staff members have not voted in determining Conference committee decisions. (See Bill's closing remarks on A.A. principles, page 3.)

QUESTIONS ANONYMOUS

(Continued)

26. What is the meaning of the large (\$10,000) "other expenses" item in Exhibit B of the financial data?

In the consolidated statement, this is a combined figure representing "other expense" items for a number of service agencies. In general, it includes a number of small items of Headquarters "housekeeping" and general running expenses.

The Vice-Chairman reiterated previous comments to the effect that all Delegates were absolutely entitled to have detailed answers to the most minute inquiries regarding finances and other aspects of Headquarters operations.

Since the auditor's working papers were not immediately available on a Sunday morning, the Delegate who raised the question was assured that he would have, by mail to his home, the complete breakdown on the item in question within the week.

Bill commented that he felt Delegates were "too polite" on occasions in not demanding more explanations of complex financial figures and that these figures were always available to them.

27. May individuals obtain copies of the Worldwide A.A. Handbook and Directory?

Yes, but only through their groups. Each group now receives one copy. Additional copies are priced, below cost, at \$1.50.

As in previous Conferences, there was detailed discussion of ways of increasing effectiveness in the distribution of Handbooks or in reducing production costs. It was agreed, however, that while every effort should be made to explore suggested procedures, the present arrangements appeared to be those most likely to serve the movement as a whole and, particularly, new groups which require the greatest amount of assistance.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

(Adopted Unanimously)

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE AGENDA

It was recommended that the present Conference Agenda be retained.

It was further recommended that the Agenda Committee, on behalf of all Delegates, wishes to thank Marian Fiske, Conference Secretary, for her work during the past year in helping to prepare the Agenda for the Sixth General Service Conference.

The Agenda Committee would like to go on record as expressing its appreciation for the excellent reports on Headquarters services presented by the Staff members during the present Conference.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE CONFERENCE REPORT

Having met and, by lot, selected a Chairman from among members attending the Conference for the second year, the Committee agreed to review the first draft of the Conference Report very carefully and to send suggestions and comments to the Conference Secretary before the deadline for preparation of the Final Report.

REPORT OF COMMITTEE ON ADMISSIONS TO THE CONFERENCE

Ontario Request

Since a second delegate from Ontario was established in the Third Legacy pamphlet, it is recommended that the request from the Ontario Delegate for additional representation be approved. It is further recommended that the Province be divided into Eastern and Western assembly areas with the assembly points to be determined by the Provincial Committeemen.

Missouri Request

Since a second delegate from Missouri was established in the Third Legacy pamphlet, it is recommended that the request from the Missouri Delegate for additional representation be approved. It is further recommended that the state be divided into Eastern and Western assembly areas with the assembly points to be determined by the state Committeemen.

The details of rotation policy will be determined by members in the areas involved.

California Request

The Committee recommends that the request to add a second delegate to the Los Angeles assembly area be held in abeyance until the next Conference.

NOTE: The additional Delegates from Ontario and Missouri will be elected in odd years and the Delegates to the 1957 Conference shall serve for only one year.

The Committee reaffirms the Assembly Plan for election of Delegates, as outlined in the Third Legacy Manual.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

(Adopted Unanimously)

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON FINANCE

While it is traditional in A.A. not to accumulate more than a prudent amount of money, we still realize that a certain amount is absolutely necessary to "carry the message to alcoholics". Since there are no dues, and since A.A. does not accept outside contributions, the necessary money can be obtained only by voluntary contributions of members and groups.

The problem is that these funds are difficult to collect from members and groups who have only a hazy idea of what the collection is for. The group member can see with his own eyes the need for money to buy coffee, purchase literature and to pay the rent. When the money is used for something a little more removed, such as for the local Inter-group Association, it is not as easy to see what the money is used for, and is harder to collect. Newer members hardly know what an Intergroup Office or Association does until it is thoroughly explained, or until they have done some work on it and used its help.

If a knowledge of local activities is sometimes vague, the General Service Office, Conference and Third Legacy in general, are even more remote and mysterious. Many group members have almost no realization of the functions of General Service Headquarters which are so vital to the life and security of A.A.

However, A.A.'s who have been to General Service Headquarters and seen it in action, are anxious to contribute because they understand what it does.

Therefore, your Committee believes that the financial problem can best be solved by increasing the knowledge of General Service Headquarters at the group and individual level. Experience shows that when individual members understand and know the purpose and need, they have little hesitancy in contributing \$2 each, and more. If this is true, we will all want to do everything we can to make sure that Committeemen and Group Representatives are so thoroughly informed as to General Headquarters that they can go to the groups and enthusiastically explain its activities and their obligations to A.A. as a whole, rather than merely ask for money for some remote and vague purpose.

Since some Representatives are not as articulate as others, and since it is hard for someone who has not been to a Conference to remember everything he is told, and because the "teaching" is diluted as it passes from Delegate to Committeeman to Representative to group it would be a good idea to put the information into written outline.

Once the group understands what General Service Headquarters is, and does, and why then we might suggest methods of fund-raising that have been successful in other groups. Some of these methods are mentioned in last year's report and in other parts of this Conference, such as the Birthday Plan, 10% of collections, Thanksgiving Week, etc.

Whichever plan any group might select, it would seem important to remind members that 5¢ per week is more than \$2.00 per year, and to use the Piggy-Bank plan to collect the nickel-per-member at each meeting. In this connection, since General Service Headquarters has always had the cart before the horse, and has had to spend

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

(Adopted Unanimously)

the money first and collect it afterwards, your Committee would like to make the following suggestion: In order to put Headquarters on a current financial basis, perhaps it would be possible to increase the weekly contribution to 10¢ per member for six months. This would mean that by October the estimated budget of General Service Headquarters would be covered . . . and current.

Then by dropping back to 5¢ per week, if all groups would send in their contributions every three months, instead of six months, then General Service Headquarters would stay on a current basis.

Summary for Action: Explain General Service Headquarters to each group twice a year, and the obligation of each member and group to A.A. as a whole.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON TRUSTEES

During the past year, your Committee on Trustees has received proposed nominations for new Trustees from the Nominating Committee and has, in each instance, approved such nominations.

The 1956 Conference has taken no action which has required the Committee to recommend any new proposals.

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON POLICY

The Committee recommends:

1. That there be an announcement in a future Headquarters bulletin reminding Group General Service Representatives that it is their duty to pass the bulletins on to the Group Secretary, and also suggesting that wherever practical and feasible the General Service Representative use a Group Post Office Box as a mailing address.
2. That, in the interest of area unity and harmonious functioning, Area Delegates receive copies of letters from the General Service Staff to Inter-groups and Institutional Committees that pertain to services and public relations in each Delegate's own area.
3. That foreign Representatives who have attended the General Service Conference as observers should receive all Conference mailings for a ten-year period.
4. That each year all Conference Committee Chairmen should be elected from second-year Delegates on the Conference Committees, since their previous experience will give continuity of service.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

(Adopted Unanimously)

REPORT OF THE LITERATURE COMMITTEE

The Committee recommends:

- That: Area delegates, through their committees, help groups to gain a better understanding of existing Conference-approved literature. And, in addition, that groups be made aware of the material contained in the Handbook section of the Handbook and Directory and that the Handbook and Directory is for the entire group's use.
- That: The next Conference reconsider the possibility of publishing the new leather-bound edition of the Book, also recommending that it be known as the "leather-bound gift Edition," rather than as the "de luxe" Edition.
- That: Since the delegates at their meeting unanimously approved of Bill's new book and that it be produced in a first-class manner, decisions as to pictures and price being left to the Board of Trustees, every effort be made to have it available for the 1956 Christmas Season.
- That: Consideration be given to the possibility of material for the specific use of the older member.
- That: Pamphlet literature for institutions continue to be made available in gift packages which represent a twenty-five percent price reduction, but, further, that the Staff member corresponding with institutional groups endeavor to incorporate in the gift packages those pamphlets most frequently requested by these groups.
- That: The Literature Committee of the Conference continue to be advised and consulted on discontinuing, revising or the adding of literature.

CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTIONS

(Adopted Unanimously)

REPORT OF THE COMMITTEE ON THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

We wish to thank the delegates to the 1956 General Service Conference for their cooperation in accepting the responsibility of establishing Grapevine committees in their respective General Service areas to stimulate the distribution of our A.A. Grapevine. It is further suggested that a plan along the lines outlined in "The New Jersey Story" be inaugurated, with the goal of carrying the message to 5,000 new readers.

It is the recommendation of the Committee that Delegates also make an attempt to search out contributors and encourage the submission of manuscripts, in order to arouse wider participation in the Grapevine.

Remember -- this is your magazine!

NOTES

The Conference approved a motion asking that General Service Headquarters designate Thanksgiving Week each year as "A.A. Gratitude Week" and that this action be noted in the annual pre-Thanksgiving appeals to the groups for funds to help support A.A.'s worldwide services.

As is customary in Conference proceedings, members of Committees are chosen by lot.

O. L. (Bud) Stout of San Diego, California, was chosen by Area Delegates to serve as Chairman of their closed session at the 1957 Conference.

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DIGEST OF AGENDA OF SIXTH ANNUAL GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE - 1956

WEDNESDAY, APRIL 18

- Evening -- Registration of Delegates
 Dinner for Delegates and Spouses
 Greetings from Bernard B. Smith, Chairman, and Bill W.
 Informal reception
-

THURSDAY, APRIL 19

- Morning -- First Session - Reports on Year's Services
- Afternoon -- Second Session - Selection of Conference Committees
 Reports on Year's Services
- Evening -- Third Session (For Area Delegates Only)
-

FRIDAY, APRIL 20

- Morning -- Fourth Session - Discussion of Area Problems
- Afternoon -- Fifth Session - Report of General Service Board
 Chairman
 Consideration of Policy Proposals
-

SATURDAY, APRIL 21

- Morning -- Sixth Session - Panel Discussions ("Reports to Areas"
 and "Organization of Area Activities")
- Afternoon -- Seventh Session - Policy Discussions
 "Policy toward Radio and Television"
 "Policy on Individual Contributions"
 "Policy on Date of Annual Trustees' Meeting"
-

SUNDAY, APRIL 22

- Morning -- Eighth Session (Special) Continuation of
 Policy Discussions
- Afternoon -- Ninth Session - Conference Committee Reports
 Closing talk by Bernard B. Smith
 Closing talk by Bill W.
-

FINANCIAL DATA

Operations of A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies for the year 1955 resulted in a combined net loss of \$13,948, it was reported to the Conference.

The A.A. Grapevine earned \$2,000 and A.A. Publishing earned \$23,000, of which \$20,000 was paid in dividends to the General Fund. As a result of costs incurred in holding the 1955 General Service Conference and the 20th Anniversary Convention in St. Louis, the General Fund lost \$19,000.

Group contributions totaled \$134,800, of which the excess of \$13,200 over office expenses of \$121,600 has been allocated as a contribution to the cost of the 1956 General Service Conference.

The above figures are exclusive of additions to the Reserve Fund of \$22,500. The changes in the consolidated financial position were the reduction of working capital by \$13,900, while the cash segregated in the Reserve Fund was increased by the \$22,500 mentioned above.

The Combined Balance Sheet for A.A.'s Headquarters service agencies as of December 31, 1955 and 1954, appears as "Exhibit A," following.

"Exhibit B" is the Combined Income Statement for the same periods.

EXHIBIT A

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
COMBINED BALANCE SHEET
DECEMBER 31, 1955 AND 1954

	DECEMBER 31, 1955					DECEMBER 31, 1954				
	General Service Board	A.A.	A.A.			General Service Board	A.A.	A.A.		
	General	Office	Publishing	Grapevine	Total	General	Office	Publishing	Grapevine	Total
ASSETS										
Cash - except Reserve Fund.....	\$ 12,831	\$ 34,567	\$ 10,838	\$ 26,171	\$ 84,407	\$ 31,131	\$ 22,834	\$ 21,515	\$ 27,222	\$102,702
Accounts receivable.....			5,496	3,459	8,955			5,366	1,887	7,253
Inventories.....			53,500		53,500			33,100		33,100
Prepaid expenses.....	452	349	1,947	7,060	9,808	1,514	128	1,053	6,680	9,375
Furniture and equipment.....			1	3,566	3,567			1	3,483	3,484
RESERVE FUND - in cash	130,364		840		131,204	106,925		1,708		108,633
Inter-company accounts:										
Receivable.....	32,410		12,783			35,368		13,920		
Payable.....		(32,783)	(840)	(11,570)		(765)	(33,155)	(1,708)	(13,660)	
Total Assets.....	176,057	2,133	84,565	28,686	291,441	174,173	(10,193)	74,955	25,612	264,547
LIABILITIES										
Accounts and accruals payable.....			\$ 11,813	\$ 4,584	\$ 16,397	\$ 1,523		\$ 5,428	\$ 4,117	\$ 11,068
Deferred income.....		\$ 13,240		36,256	49,496		\$ 914		35,640	36,554
Total Liabilities.....		13,240	11,813	40,840	65,893	1,523	914	5,428	39,757	47,622
NET WORTH										
Capital stock outstanding.....			500	1				500	1	
Investment in above stock.....	(\$ 501)					(501)				
Accumulated Income:										
Balance, January 1.....	173,151	(11,107)	69,027	(14,146)	216,925	161,473	(9,522)	70,197	(18,987)	203,161
Excess of Income (Expense) (Ex. B).....	(39,164)	None	23,225	1,991	(13,948)	(22,254)	(1,585)	18,830	4,841	(168)
Dividends.....	20,000		(20,000)			20,000		(20,000)		
Additions to RESERVE FUND - Note A.....	22,571				22,571	13,932				13,932
Balance, December 31.....	176,558	(11,107)	72,252	(12,155)	225,548	173,151	(11,107)	69,027	(14,146)	216,925
Total Liabilities and Net Worth	176,057	2,133	84,565	28,686	291,441	174,173	(10,193)	74,955	25,612	264,547
Parentheses denote red figures										
NOTE A: Additions to Reserve Fund:										
Book discounts donated.....	\$ 19,335					\$ 9,181				
Interest on savings accounts.....	3,216					2,408				
Other gifts.....	20					2,343				
Totals	22,571					13,932				

EXHIBIT B

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS PUBLISHING, INC.
THE ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
COMBINED INCOME STATEMENT
YEARS ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1955 AND 1954

	YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1955					YEAR ENDED DECEMBER 31, 1954				
	General Service Board	A.A.	A.A.			General Service Board	A.A.	A.A.		
	<u>General</u>	<u>Office</u>	<u>Publishing</u>	<u>Grapevine</u>	<u>Total</u>	<u>General</u>	<u>Office</u>	<u>Publishing</u>	<u>Grapevine</u>	<u>Total</u>
WE RECEIVED FROM:										
Sales of Books:										
Alcoholics Anonymous			\$ 86,481		\$ 86,481			\$ 53,658		\$ 53,658
12 Steps and 12 Traditions			14,647		14,647			21,981		21,981
Sales of Pamphlets, etc.			64,883		64,883			64,690		64,690
Sales of and subs. to Grapevine				\$ 96,571	96,571				\$ 87,232	87,232
Total Sales					262,582					227,561
Contributions for Office Expenses		\$121,621			121,621		\$117,190			117,190
Total Income		121,621	166,011	96,571	384,203		117,190	140,329	87,232	344,751
WE SPENT FOR:										
Cost of products sold			74,600	38,932	113,532			60,392	33,300	93,692
Shipping and mailing costs			13,391	9,844	23,235			12,035	9,049	21,084
Services - Salaries		75,808	24,536	29,130	129,474		71,163	21,287	24,410	116,860
- Writers' fees			2,184		2,184			5,767		5,767
- Legal and accounting	\$ 1,400		2,100	1,325	4,825	\$ 1,747		2,211	1,000	4,958
- Honorarium	2,000				2,000	2,000				2,000
Rent, light and telephone	1,200	15,042	5,438	3,344	25,024	1,200	14,270	5,346	3,289	24,105
*Printing	2,780	17,256			20,036	5,134	14,103			19,237
Stationery and office supplies		3,347		2,732	6,079		4,750		3,249	7,999
New equipment or depreciation		812	54	658	1,524		4,479	1,730	592	6,801
Taxes and insurance	326	3,577	426	1,492	5,821	326	2,722	433	1,451	4,932
Trustees' Meetings	4,022				4,022	3,444				3,444
Editing and research			15,191		15,191			6,767		6,767
Bedford Hills expense			3,787		3,787			3,980		3,980
Travel, entertainment, promotion			880	2,916	3,796			747	2,340	3,087
Other expenses		5,779	199	4,207	10,185	98	7,288	804	3,711	11,901
Net deficit:										
General Service Conference	11,442				11,442	8,305				8,305
20th Anniversary Convention	15,994				15,994					
Total Expense	39,164	121,621	142,786	94,580	398,151	22,254	118,775	121,499	82,391	344,919
Excess of Income (Expense) (Ex. A)	(39,164)	None	23,225	1,991	(13,948)	(22,254)	(1,585)	18,830	4,841	(168)

*Other than printing costs of products sold

Additions to Reserve Fund and dividends paid by A.A. Publishing, Inc. to the General Fund are shown on the attached Exhibit A.

Parentheses denote red figures.

1956 GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
Roster of Delegates

- Andersen, Chris, 318 Bay 13th St., Brooklyn, New York
Barton, Leo H., 1226 Arthur Street, Fresno, California
* Beveridge, Paul D., 2010 S. E. Sherman, Portland, Oregon
* Bonneville, Pierre, 3430 Fullum St., Montreal, Quebec, Canada
* Breen, Richard, 1440 St. Ann, Jackson, Mississippi
- * Breyley, Naomi, Route 2, Manitou, Kentucky
Brown, Charlie, 414 Crown Bldg., 615 West Pender St., Vancouver 2, B.C., Canada
Caron, Richard J., 19 Wyomissing Hills Boulevard, West Lawn, Pennsylvania
Cassady, Burt J., Jr., 2037 Dartmouth Place, Charlotte, North Carolina
Chancey, Bryan, 521 Massey Building, Birmingham, Alabama
- * Clarkieu, George L., Box 379, Green Bay, Wisconsin
* Davey, Dan D., Locke Hotel, Pierre, South Dakota
Delaney, Frank J., 1217 Windsor Avenue, Windsor, Connecticut
* Devine, Henry, 30 Cheney Place, Manchester, New Hampshire
* Dower, Doug, Box 622, Chatham, N. B., Canada
- * Evans, Edward M., 3009 Fulton St., Toledo, Ohio
Falloon, James H., 4205 Russell Ave., Mt. Rainier, Maryland
* Farrell, Don, 108 South 53rd St., Omaha, Nebraska
Fergeman, George, 1603 West 4th St., Waterloo, Iowa
* Ferguson, Don G., 6 Wakefield Apts., 415 Stradbroke Ave., Winnipeg, Manitoba, Canada
- Fors, Carl A., Box 805, Lansing, Michigan
* Fussa, Bartolome Bonet, Granada St., #195, Urbanizacion Valencia, Rio Piedras, Puerto Rico
Green, Winton, 910 Bruce St., Tampa, Florida
* Griffith, H.P., Cornell Arms, Columbia, South Carolina
Gross, Maurice, 203 South Forrest St., Forrest City, Arkansas
- Hall, Clayton B., Sr., 103 Ballard Avenue, Syracuse, New York
* Hall, Waldo F., Box 245, Staples, Minnesota
* Hankins, Gaylord, 2611 Circle J, San Angelo, Texas
* Hastings, Rowland J., Jr., Box 281, Augusta, Maine
Henry, Jack, Box 1205, Fort Worth, Texas
- * Hill, Maryan E., 234 Hawthorne, Memphis, Tennessee
Hillmer, B. Whitney, 217 Essex St., Sarnia, Ontario, Canada
* Holmes, J. Edward, 420 West Avenue, Pawtucket, Rhode Island
* Hoyer, Harry, 1618 McCormick St., Wichita, Kansas
Johnson, Gordon, 201 East Vanderbilt, Orlando, Florida
- Johnson, Howard S., 1012 Adams St., Richland, Washington
Joy, William C., Box 416, Flat Rock, Michigan
Judd, Maurice W., Apt. 210, 127 Locust St., Evansville, Indiana
Kelly, E. P., 730 Zaffke St., Fort Atkinson, Wisconsin
Lanpher, Murray, 1749 Princeton Avenue, St. Paul 5, Minnesota
* Loftus, Mike, 1723 N. Montford Avenue, Baltimore, Maryland

1956 GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
Roster of Delegates
(Continued)

-
- Lowe, Thomas, Box 1068, Logan, West Virginia
 - * McLean, Frank J., 6525 - 107th St., Edmonton, Alberta, Canada
 - Manzi, Nancy, 9 Congress St., Worcester, Massachusetts
 - Marineau, Al, 3643 Lankershim Boulevard, Los Angeles, California
 - Matheson, George F., 4016 North Keystone, Chicago, Illinois
 - * Matthews, James W., Jr., Custer City, Pennsylvania
 - * Meagher, Jack R., 82 South 22nd St., Battle Creek, Michigan
 - * Moran, Joseph J., 1434 Nix Professional Building, San Antonio, Texas
 - * Myers, Thomas, Hughton, Saskatchewan, Canada
 - * O'Brien, James P., 723 East 57th St., Savannah, Georgia
 - * Olsen, Harve, 512 First Ave., So., New Rockford, North Dakota
 - O'Toole, Peter J., 17 Elwood Place, Newark, N. J.
 - * Owens, J. W., 1033 Pecos Trail, Sante Fe, New Mexico
 - * Pebley, Gleason, Georgetown Road, Penns Grove, New Jersey
 - Poe, Lane, 904 East Drive, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma
 - * Potts, Herbert, 2925 N. Harrison St., Wilmington, Delaware
 - * Reece, Joe, 1101 Maryland Avenue, Butte, Montana
 - Reese, Clifford D., Lakeview, Provo, Utah
 - Robinson, Thomas W., 14 Vernon Terrace, Alexandria, Virginia
 - Sawyer, Bob, 1508 Craig Drive, Galena Park, Texas
 - Shaffer, Ray, 1030 Orange Street, Coshocton, Ohio
 - * Shea, J. Anthony, 28 Prospect Street, Ware, Massachusetts
 - * Smith, H. Lyle, 215 South Lincoln, Pocatello, Idaho
 - * Stout, O. L. (Bud), 3163 Kalmia Street, San Diego, California
 - Tonies, Gerard B., 454 North 24th St., East St. Louis, Illinois
 - * Tucker, Clyde, 2 Ascutney Street, Windsor, Vermont
 - Veigle, Charles J., Bethlehem Steel Company, Johnstown, Pennsylvania
 - Warner, James, Box 495, Shreveport, Louisiana
 - Werntz, Orville, Warrensburg, Missouri
 - * Whitney, George, Box 76, Loudonville, N. Y.
 - * Whitney, Richard H., c/o Hollister-Whitney, Box 77, Quincy, Illinois
 - Whittier, Glen, 318 West Main, Sterling, Colorado
 - Wilsey, Stan, 110 Toyon Drive, Fairfax, California
 - * Woodruff, J. Carleton, 4344 East Whitman, Tucson, Arizona
-

Foreign Observers

- Dillon, Val, Box 8, Dersley, Transvaal, South Africa (Union of S. Africa)
- Frylink, Adrian, Box 55, Babylon, New York (Netherlands)
- Mallins, Sackville O'C., 96 Sandford Road, Ranelagh, Dublin, Ireland (Ireland)
- Sonju, Hart, 203 West 108th Street, New York, N. Y. (Norway)
- * New Delegate (Panel 6)

1956 CONFERENCE MEMBERS
(Trustees & Headquarters)

TRUSTEES

NON-ALCOHOLIC

Mr. Jack Alexander
c/o Saturday Evening Post
Philadelphia, Pennsylvania

Mr. Frank B. Amos
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North White Plains, N. Y.

Mr. Frank Gulden
50 Elizabeth Street
New York 13, N. Y.

Mr. Leonard V. Harrison, Vice-Chairman
105 East 22nd Street
New York 10, N. Y.

Dr. John L. Norris
Medical Department
Eastman Kodak Company
Rochester, N. Y.

Mr. Archibald B. Roosevelt, Treasurer
200 East 66th Street
New York, N. Y.

Mr. Bernard B. Smith, Chairman
460 Park Avenue
New York 22, N. Y.

TRUSTEE EMERITUS

Mr. A. LeRoy Chipman
Midston House
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Marian Fiske
Ann Macfarlane
Eve Marsh
Hazel Rice
Lib Symington

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Don Goddard, Chairman-Editor
J. Seegar Heavilin
Tom O'Brien, Jr., Vice-Chairman
Sigurd P. Sandmore

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Katharine Swentzel
Sarah Thompson

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Richard Stevens

OTHERS ATTENDING CONFERENCE

A.A. GRAPEVINE INC.

Eleanor Burns
Ed Wells
Doris Holmes

OFFICE STAFF

Dolores Dalziel
Dennis Manders
Nell Wing

CONSULTANTS

Ralph W. Bugli (Editorial)
Wilbur A. Smith (Ind. CPA)

1955 CONTRIBUTIONS BY GROUPS TO THE
GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND

<u>U.S.A. STATE</u>	<u>Reported No. of Grps</u>	<u>No. of Grps Contrib.</u>	<u>% of Grps Contrib.</u>	<u>Amount of Contrib.</u>	<u>Membership</u>	<u>Contrib. Per Capita</u>
Alabama	40	30	75%	\$ 1,373.50	1,104	\$ 1.24
Arizona	41	29	71	905.52	523	1.73
Arkansas	54	41	76	1,444.50	1,061	1.36
California	588	404	69	20,132.10	12,998	1.55
Colorado	48	31	65	2,019.80	1,081	1.87
Connecticut	50	27	54	1,084.50	1,057	1.03
Delaware	16	10	63	533.00	356	1.50
District of Columbia	14	8	57	461.00	412	1.12
Florida	132	91	70	5,668.41	2,696	2.10
Georgia	49	25	51	841.00	981	.86
Idaho	22	17	77	626.65	312	2.01
Illinois	387	366	95	3,948.00	7,921	.50
Indiana	104	104	100	2,464.55	1,668	1.48
Iowa	80	48	60	1,914.81	1,674	1.14
Kansas	69	45	65	1,956.10	1,334	1.47
Kentucky	49	43	88	1,200.63	692	1.74
Louisiana	39	24	61	1,100.15	931	1.18
Maine	39	22	56	698.97	580	1.21
Maryland	56	38	68	1,605.00	941	1.71
Massachusetts	133	79	60	3,103.15	2,594	1.20
Michigan	195	133	68	7,825.48	3,874	2.02
Minnesota	113	55	49	3,076.96	3,070	1.00
Mississippi	33	21	64	938.00	685	1.37
Missouri	108	83	77	3,512.81	2,362	1.49
Montana	25	14	56	420.90	338	1.25
Nebraska	38	22	58	609.80	446	1.37
Nevada	9	7	78	366.00	217	1.69
New Hampshire	20	11	55	360.00	260	1.38
New Jersey	130	60	46	2,744.50	2,407	1.14
New Mexico	35	21	60	667.00	779	.86
New York	309	158	51	7,587.25	7,239	1.05
North Carolina	120	61	51	2,386.40	2,061	1.16
North Dakota	38	19	50	515.00	481	1.07
Ohio	324	163	50	6,148.70	8,284	.74
Oklahoma	63	48	76	3,842.50	1,072	3.58
Oregon	53	36	68	956.30	784	1.22
Pennsylvania	211	136	64	4,629.53	3,748	1.24
Rhode Island	19	4	21	146.00	275	.53
South Carolina	53	29	55	831.00	926	.90
South Dakota	31	17	55	681.00	595	1.14
Tennessee	38	22	58	1,180.53	907	1.30
Texas	222	140	63	7,428.75	4,532	1.64
Utah	42	23	55	640.00	1,041	.61
Vermont	20	14	70	537.00	333	1.61
Virginia	80	50	63	2,528.00	1,928	1.31
Washington	91	59	65	2,152.28	1,534	1.40
West Virginia	44	23	52	960.00	683	1.41
Wisconsin	120	84	70	3,220.60	2,011	1.60
Wyoming	16	11	69	405.00	160	2.53
Total For U.S.A.	4,610	3,006	65%	\$120,378.63	93,951	\$ 1.28

GENERAL SERVICE HEADQUARTERS FUND CONTRIBUTIONS

(Continued)

CANADA

Northwest Territories					1	
Alberta	48	22	46%	\$ 693.21	760	\$.91
British Columbia	98	59	60	3,601.99	1,868	1.94
Manitoba	25	17	68	750.73	616	1.22
New Brunswick	24	8	30	280.00	534	.52
Newfoundland	8	2	25	97.00	89	1.09
Nova Scotia	35	29	83	776.62	582	1.33
Ontario	195	117	60	3,738.93	3,041	1.23
Prince Edward Isle	6	2	33	55.00	130	.42
Quebec	83	35	42	863.50	1,329	.65
Saskatchewan	51	25	49	580.20	586	.99
Yukon Territory	<u>1</u>	<u>1</u>	<u>100</u>	<u>12.00</u>	<u>9</u>	<u>1.33</u>
Total For Canada	574	317	55%	\$ 11,449.18	9,545	\$ 1.20
Total For U.S.A. and Canada	5,184	3,323	64%	131,827.81	103,496	1.27

FOREIGN 564 \$ 1,614.50 14,278

*LONE MEMBERS 391.74 290

INTERNATIONALISTS 160.00 119

ANONYMOUS DONORS 1,509.60

HOSPITAL GROUPS 211 240.00 4,956

PRISON GROUPS 290 226.10 13,056

GRAND TOTAL 6,249 \$135,578.01 135,905

* Contributions of Lone Members included in State, Province and Foreign totals.

THE A. A. GRAPEVINE

Individual Subscriptions, Paid Bulk
Monthly Bulk and Total Circulation

UNITED STATES

State	Ind.	Pd. Bulk	Mo. Bulk	Total	State	Ind.	Pd. Bulk	Mo. Bulk	Total
Alabama	108	29	85	222	South Carolina	105	46	160	311
Arizona	98	22	88	208	South Dakota	111	14	86	211
Arkansas	193	41	111	345	Tennessee	98	5	111	214
California	1707	762	1447	3916	Texas	820	184	524	1528
Colorado	203	78	107	388	Utah	132	12	82	226
Connecticut	177	76	225	478	Vermont	62	19	110	191
Delaware	54	34	6	94	Virginia	313	87	260	660
Dist. of Col.	266	10	15	291	Washington	222	88	269	579
Florida	371	161	447	979	West Virginia	118	40	167	325
Georgia	131	70	161	362	Wisconsin	335	109	259	703
Idaho	49	39	73	161	Wyoming	65	6	15	86
Illinois	753	112	539	1404	Totals	14622	4346	12310	31278
Indiana	268	123	153	544	CANADA				
Iowa	248	63	265	576	Alberta	125	15	145	285
Kansas	334	147	109	590	British Col.	217	69	213	499
Kentucky	142	25	86	253	Manitoba	77	33	124	234
Louisiana	156	44	142	342	New Brunswick	28		136	164
Maine	86	42	123	251	Newfoundland	25		6	31
Maryland	285	19	97	401	Nova Scotia	65	22	193	280
Massachusetts	995	120	196	1311	Ontario	355	202	668	1225
Michigan	655	177	528	1360	Prince Edward	11		23	34
Minnesota	545	114	211	870	Quebec	102	16	180	298
Mississippi	90	44	90	224	Saskatchewan	120	38	52	210
Missouri	476	86	150	712	Yukon	1			1
Montana	84	11	27	122	Totals	1126	395	1740	3261
Nebraska	145	47	30	222	U.S. Possessions	42	53	12	107
Nevada	31	20	30	81	Foreign	402	167		569
New Hampshire	53	28	39	120	Totals	444	220	12	676
New Jersey	258	159	764	1181	Totals	16192	4961	14062	35215
New Mexico	92	26	44	162					
New York	847	375	1829	3051					
North Carolina	250	133	426	809					
North Dakota	69	10	38	117					
Ohio	799	203	654	1656					
Oklahoma	330	12	176	518					
Oregon	146	72	174	392					
Pennsylvania	678	200	563	1441					
Rhode Island	69	2	19	90					

1956 CONFERENCE COMMITTEES

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